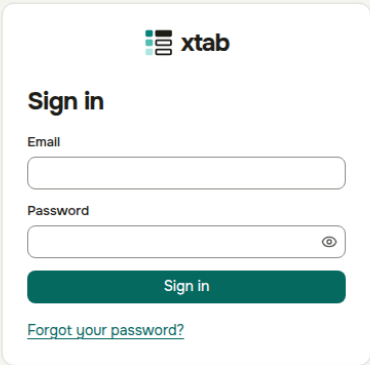
xtab user guide

How to work with xtab: sign in, set up a workspace, a base and tables, enter records, set up fields and views, search, and move data from spreadsheets and back. The guide describes version 0.4 and grows with every release.

Signing in

Your first letter from xtab is an invitation with a link. Open the link, enter your name, make up a password of at least 12 characters and click **Join**. The link works once.

Next time, open the address of xtab, enter your e-mail and password and click **Sign in**. To check that you typed the password correctly, click the eye icon on the right of the password field — the password becomes visible; click it again to hide it.



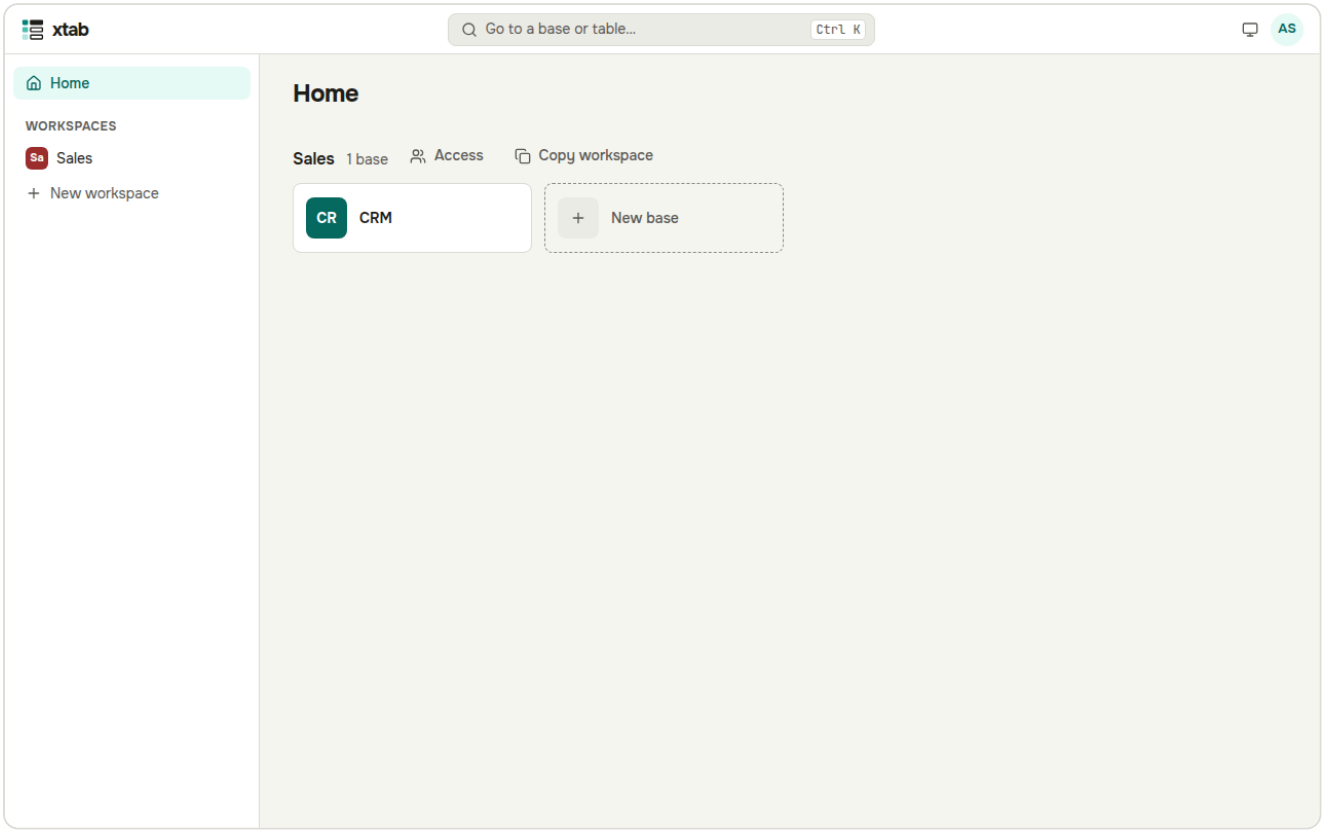
The sign-in page

If you forgot your password, click **Forgot your password?**, enter your e-mail and click **Send a link**. Set a new password by the link in the letter.

To sign out, click the circle with your initials in the top right corner and choose **Sign out**.

Home: workspaces and bases

After you sign in, the home page opens. On the left are the workspaces: each gathers the bases of one department or line of work. On the right are the bases of each workspace as tiles.



Home with a workspace and a base

- **New workspace:** on the left, click **New workspace**, enter a name and press Enter.
- **New base:** in the workspace you need, click the tile **New base**, enter a name and press Enter. The base opens right away.
- **Open a base:** click its tile.
- **Go to a workspace:** click it in the list on the left.
- **Copy a workspace** (for the owner of the workspace): click **Copy workspace** next to its name, change the name if you like and click **Copy**. The copy gets all the bases of the workspace with their data; you own it, the members of the source do not move to the copy.

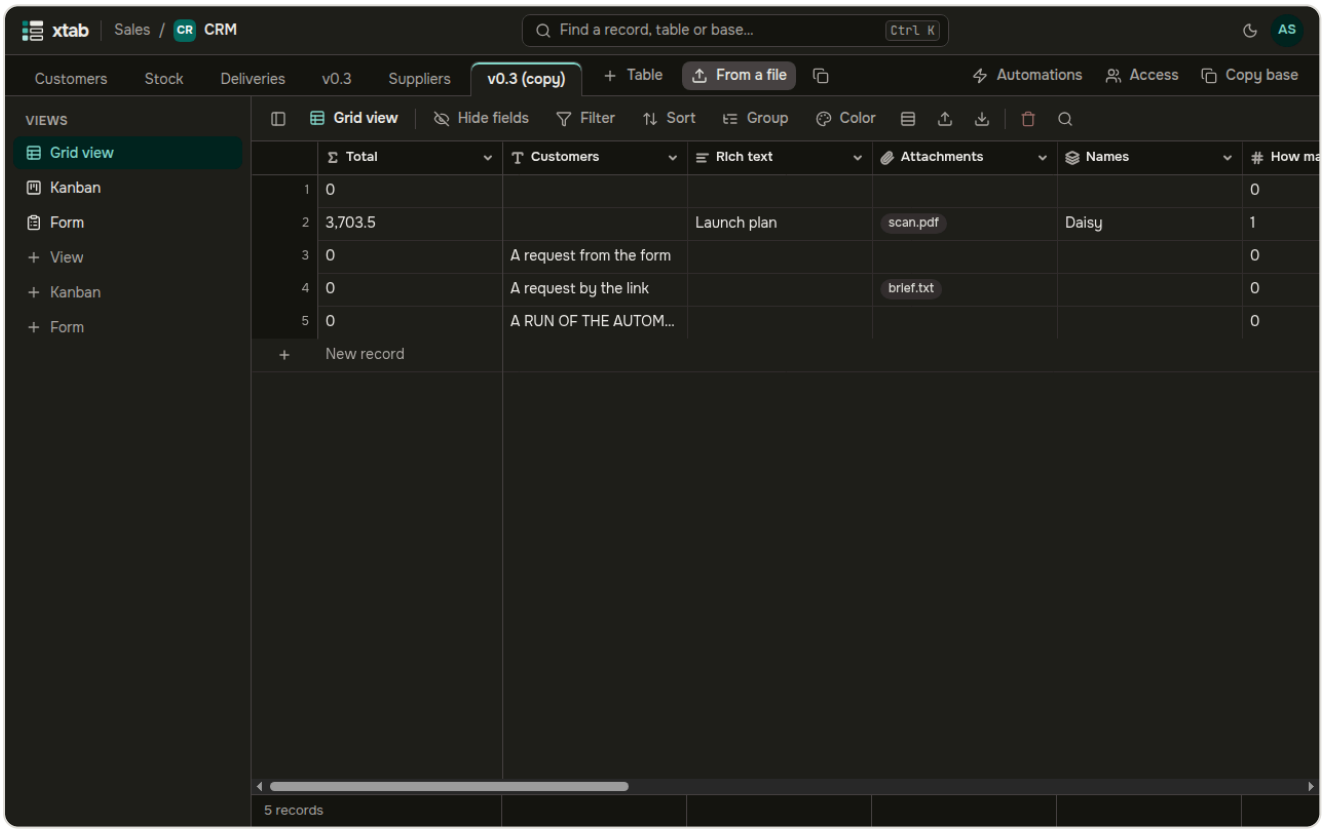
Base and tables

The tables of a base are the tabs under the top bar. The first table opens.

- **New table:** click **+ Table** to the right of the tabs, enter a name and press Enter. A new table already has the field «Name».
- **A table from a CSV or Excel file:** click **From a file** to the right of the tabs — see «Import from CSV and Excel».

- **Another table:** click its tab.
- **Copy a table:** open the table and click the copy icon to the right of **From a file**, change the name if you like and click **Copy**. The copy shows up as a new tab with the same fields, records, files and shared views. If the table links to another one, that one gets an inverse field named after the copy.
- **Copy a base:** click **Copy base** at the end of the row of tabs. The copy opens right away with all its tables, the links between them, views and automations. The automations of the copy are turned off and have no secrets: turn them on and set the secrets again when you are ready.

A copy holds the data of the moment you clicked **Copy**: changes made while it is being copied do not get into it. A large base takes a few minutes; the button shows «Copying...». Public links of forms and personal views are not copied.

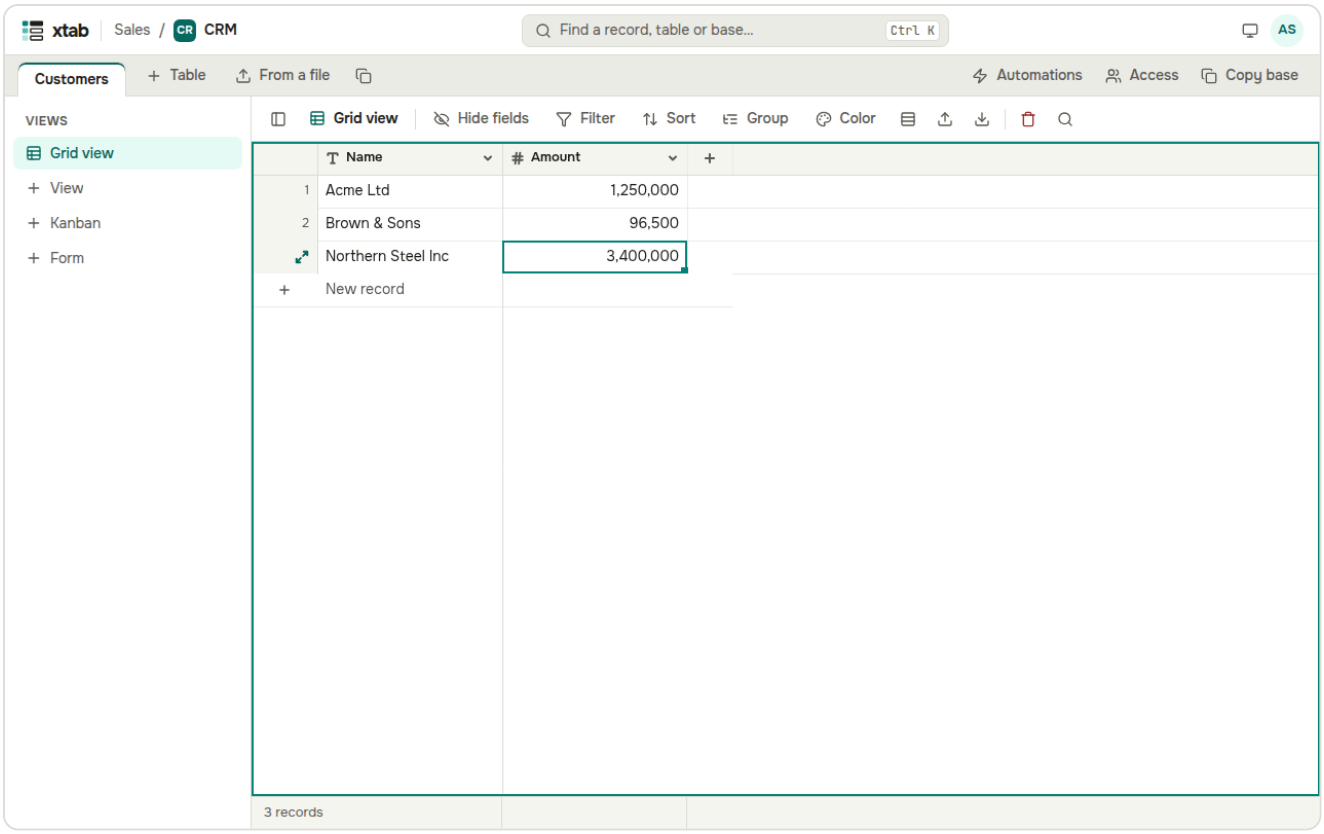


A copy of a table as a new tab

The top bar shows which workspace and base you are in. To go back home, click the xtab logo on the left.

Records in a table

A table shows records as rows and fields as columns. The first column is the primary field of a record: it stays in place when the table scrolls to the right. The number of records in the view is shown at the bottom.



A table with records

- **Select a cell:** click it. Move between cells with the arrows, Tab, Page Up and Page Down, Home and End.
- **Change a value:** press Enter or double-click the cell, or just start typing. Enter or Tab save the value, Esc cancels the edit. Numbers can be typed with commas: `1,250,000.50`.
- **Checkbox:** press Enter or click the selected cell again.
- **Clear a cell:** press Delete.
- **New record:** click the row **New record** under the last record.
- **New record below the selected one:** press Shift+Enter.
- **Delete a record:** select any of its cells, click the bin above the table and confirm.

Fields the system fills (created time, created by, autonumber) cannot be changed.

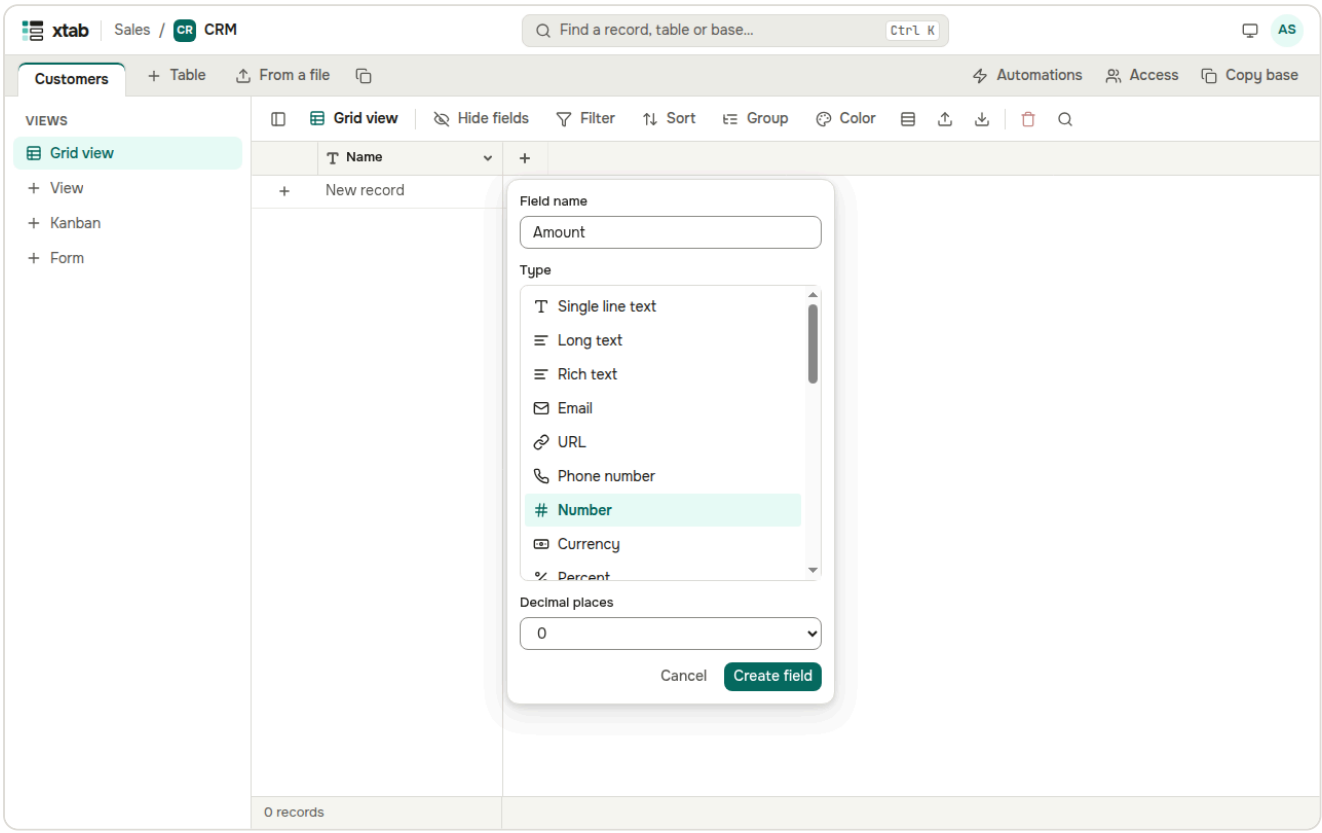
Fields

Every field has a type, and its icon is shown in the column header.

- **Text and contacts:** single line text, long text, email, URL, phone number.
- **Numbers:** number, currency, percent, duration, rating.
- **Choices:** checkbox, single select, multiple select, user.
- **Dates:** date, date and time.

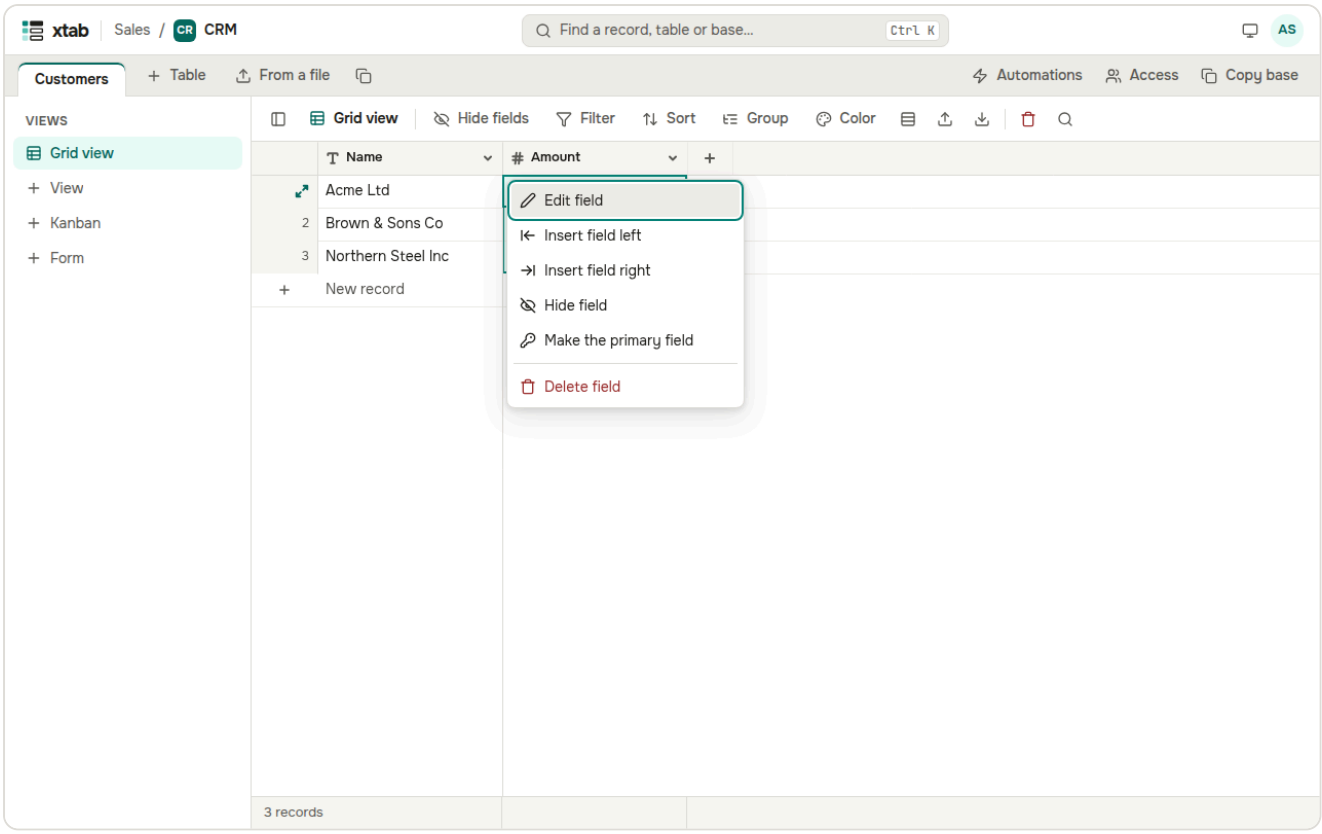
- **Links between tables:** link, lookup, count, rollup.
- **Calculations:** formula.
- **Files:** attachments.
- **Filled in by the system:** autonumber, created or last modified time, created or last modified by.

A new field at the end of the table: click **+** to the right of the last column, enter a name, choose a type and click **Create field**.



A new field

The menu of a field: click the header of its column.

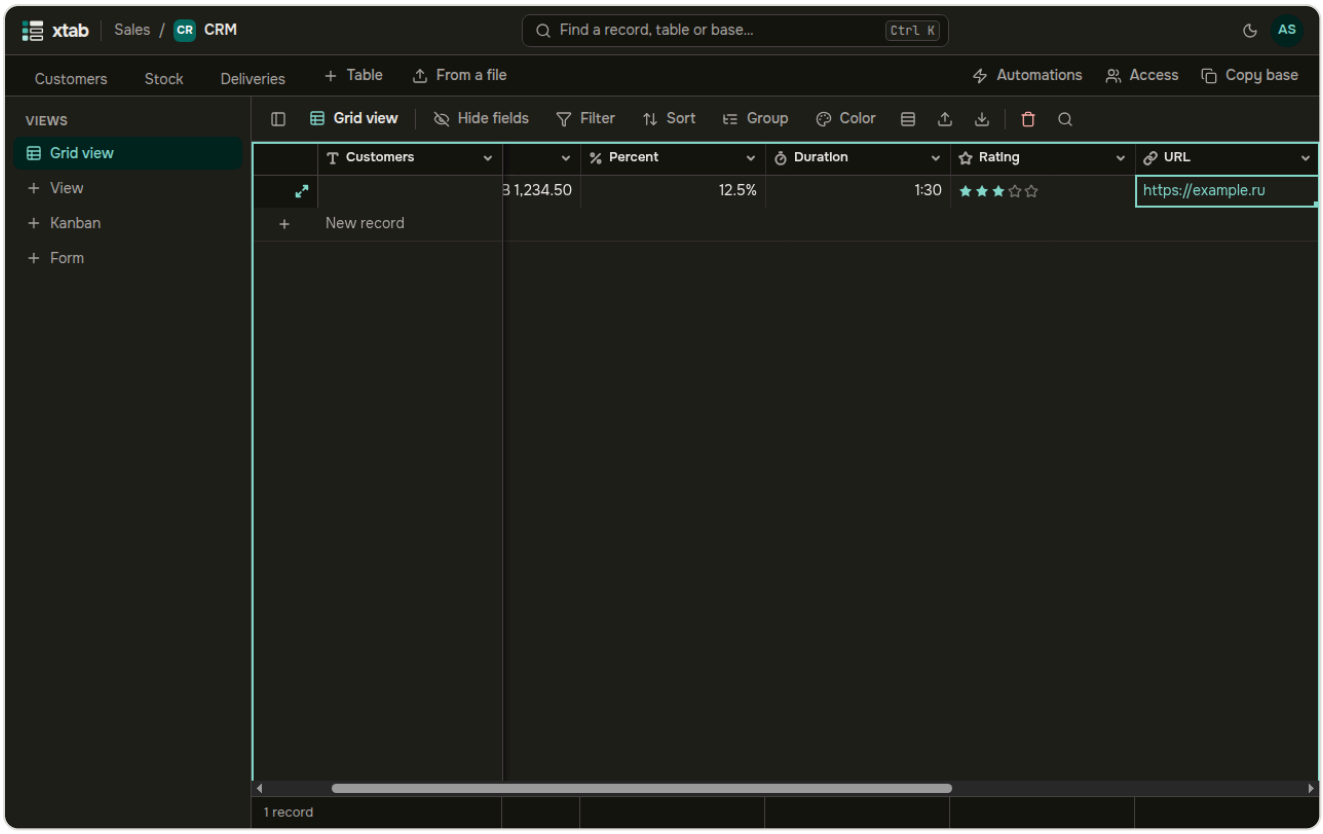


The menu of a field

- **Edit field** — a new name, the options of a list (one per line), the number of decimal places, or the text of a formula.
- **Insert field left** or **right** — a new field next to this one.
- **Make the primary field** — the field becomes the first column and the name of the record: its value is what links, the quick switcher and the record title show. A formula can be the primary field too.
- **Hide field** — the column disappears from this view; the data stays.
- **Delete field** — the field is deleted with all its values after you confirm. The primary field cannot be deleted.

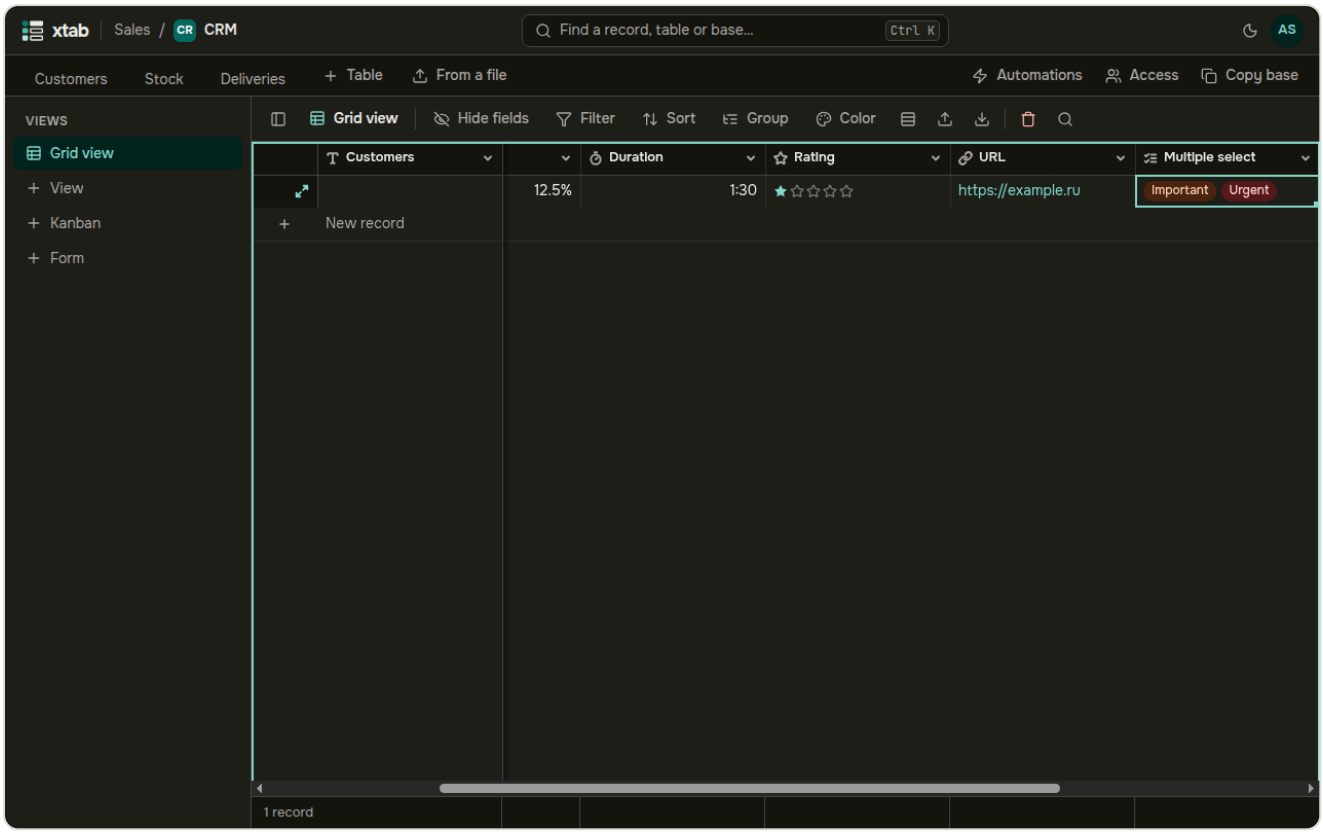
Values of different field types

- **Currency, percent, duration:** type the way you are used to: `1,234.50`, `12.5`, `1:30`. xtab adds the currency sign, the percent sign and the hours and minutes.
- **Rating:** click the star you want.
- **Email and URL:** the address becomes a link.



Currency, percent, duration, rating and URL

- **Multiple select:** select the cell and press Enter, then tick the options. They appear in the cell in the order you ticked them.
- **User:** press Enter, start typing a member's name and pick them from the list. The field setting **Several people in a cell** allows more than one person.



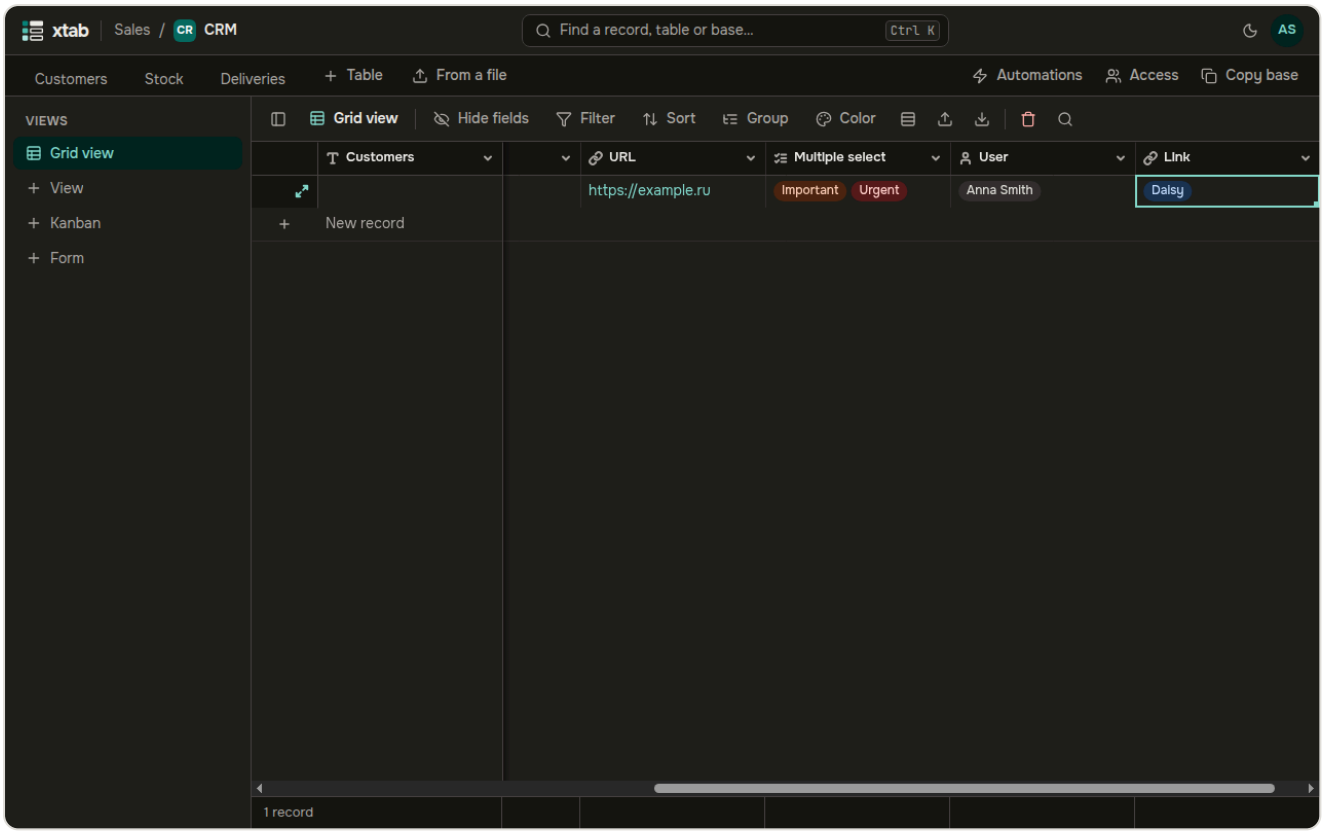
Multiple select and user

Links between tables

A **Link** field connects a record with records of another table: for example, a customer with their suppliers.

Create a link: add a field of type **Link** and choose the **Linked table**. Turn on **One record only** if a cell should hold a single record. The linked table gets a field back, so the link is visible from both sides.

Link records: select the cell and press Enter, find a record by its name and pick it from the list. The cross on a pill removes the link.



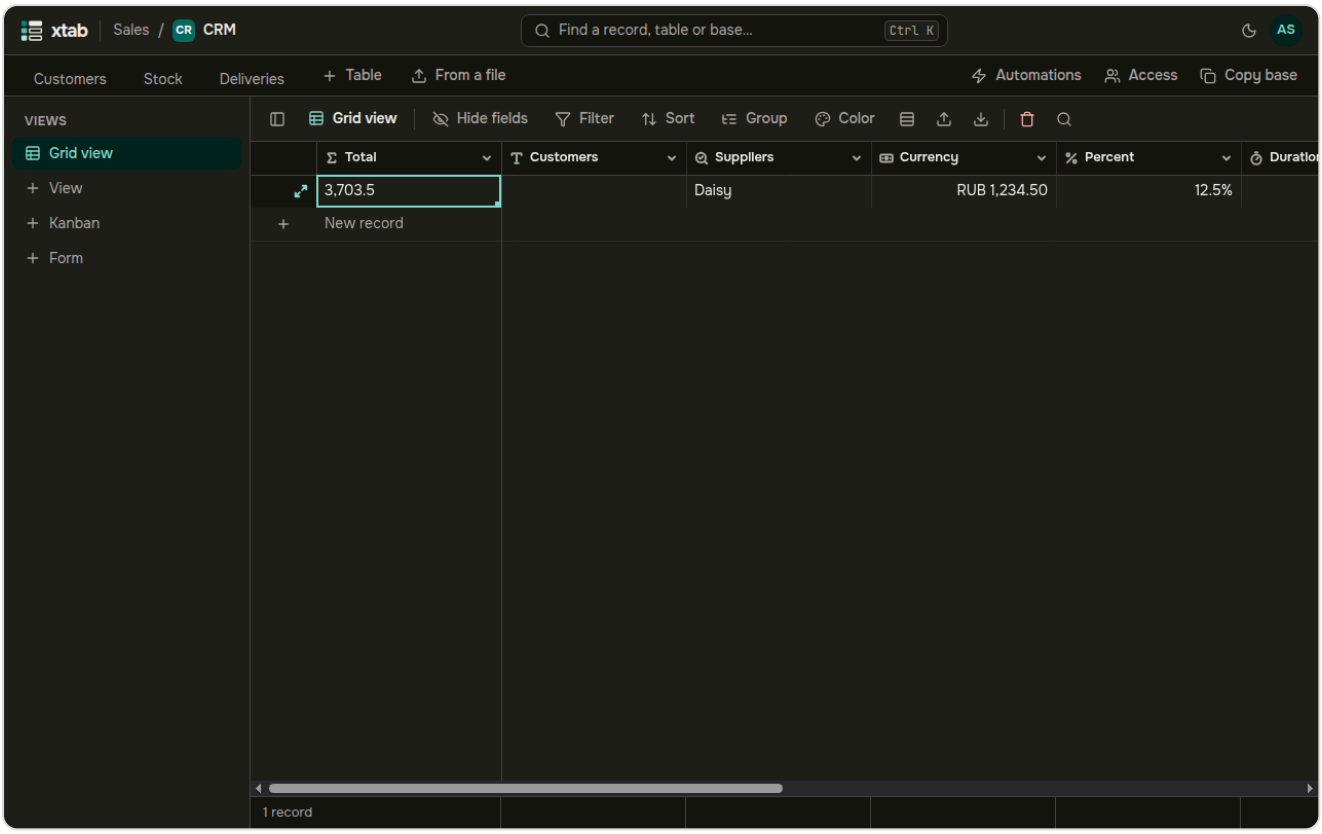
A link to a record of another table

- Links can be pasted from the clipboard as the names of the linked records.
- Records can be filtered, sorted and grouped by a link — by the names of the linked records.
- An export writes the names of the linked records.

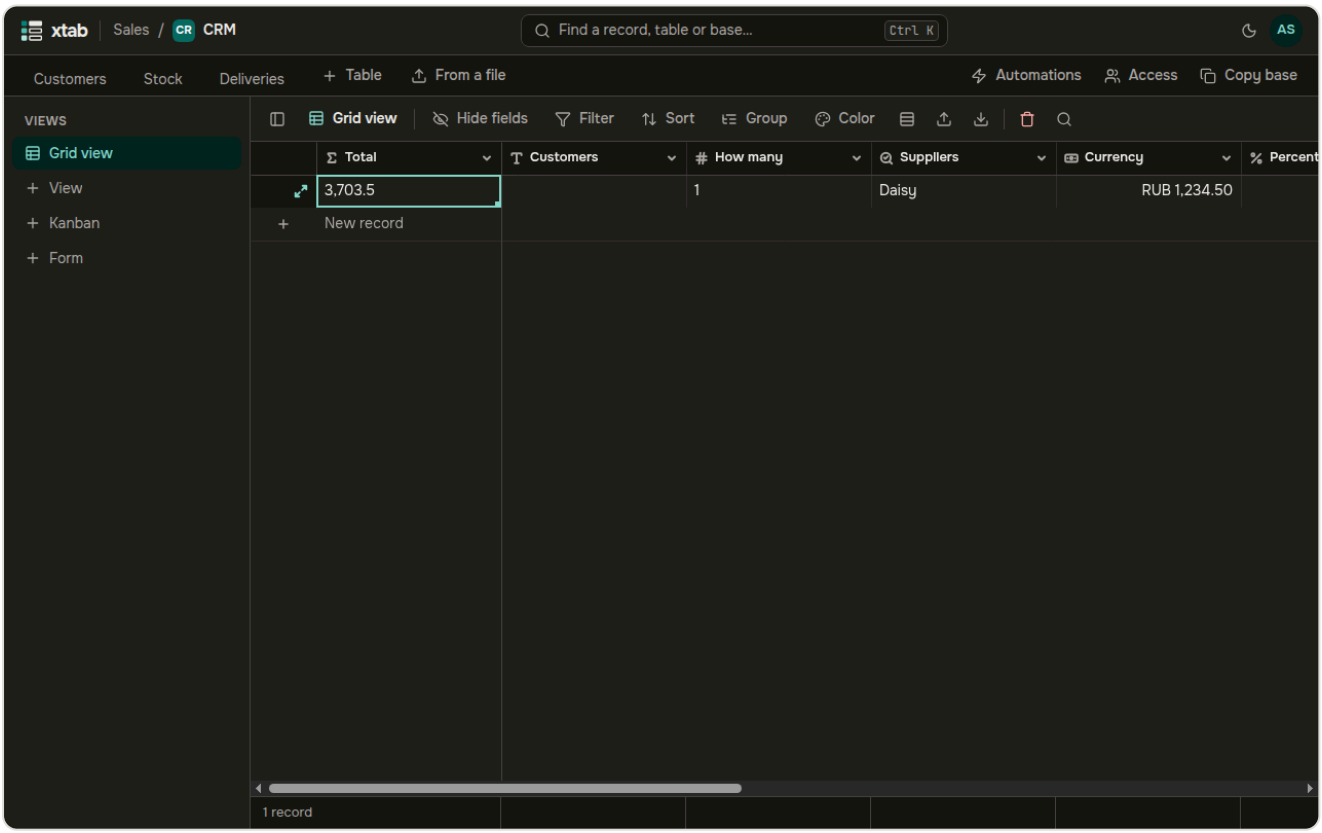
Lookup, count and rollup

These fields take data from linked records and update themselves when the linked records change.

- **Lookup** shows the values of a chosen field of the linked records, such as the cities of the suppliers. In the field form choose the **Link field** and the **Field of the linked table**.
- **Count** counts the linked records. Choose the **Link field**.



A lookup of supplier names

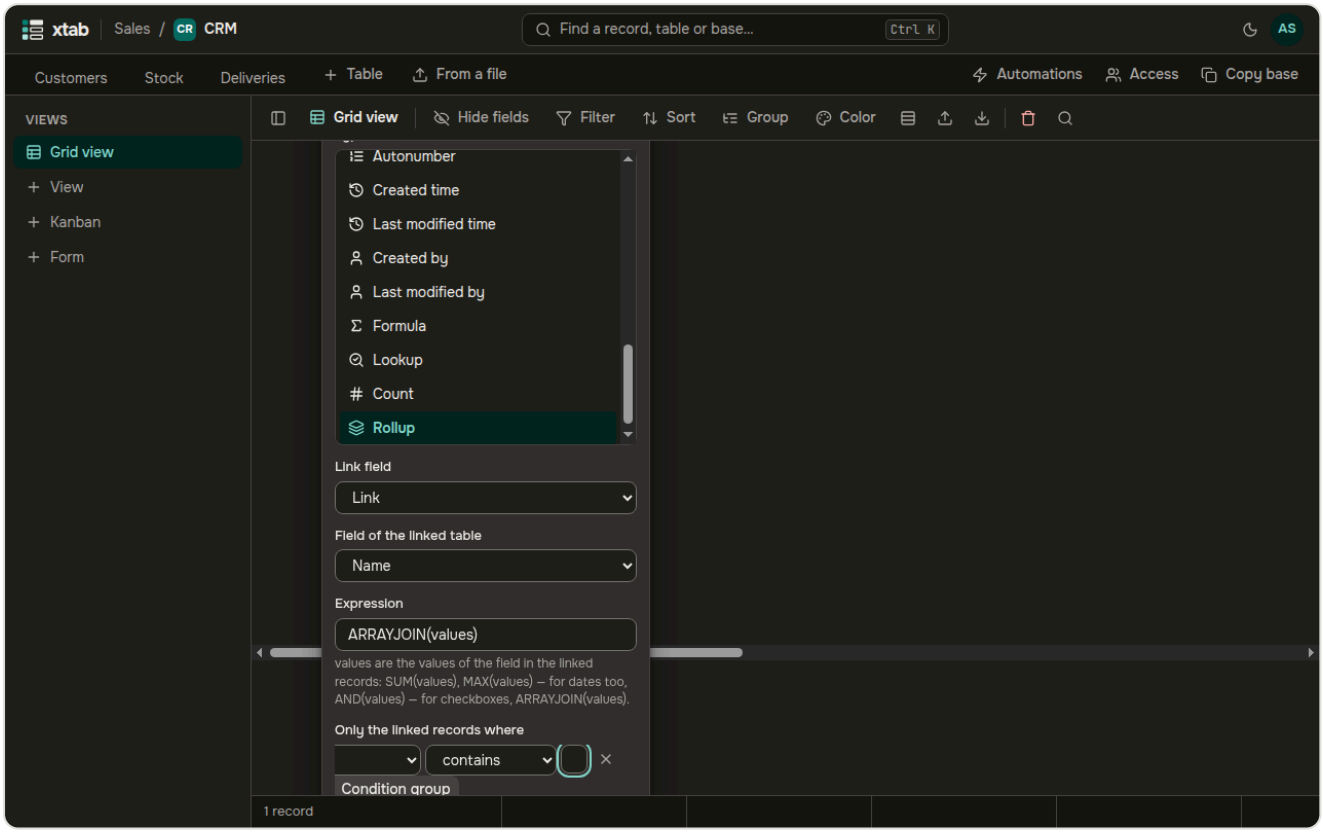


The count of linked records

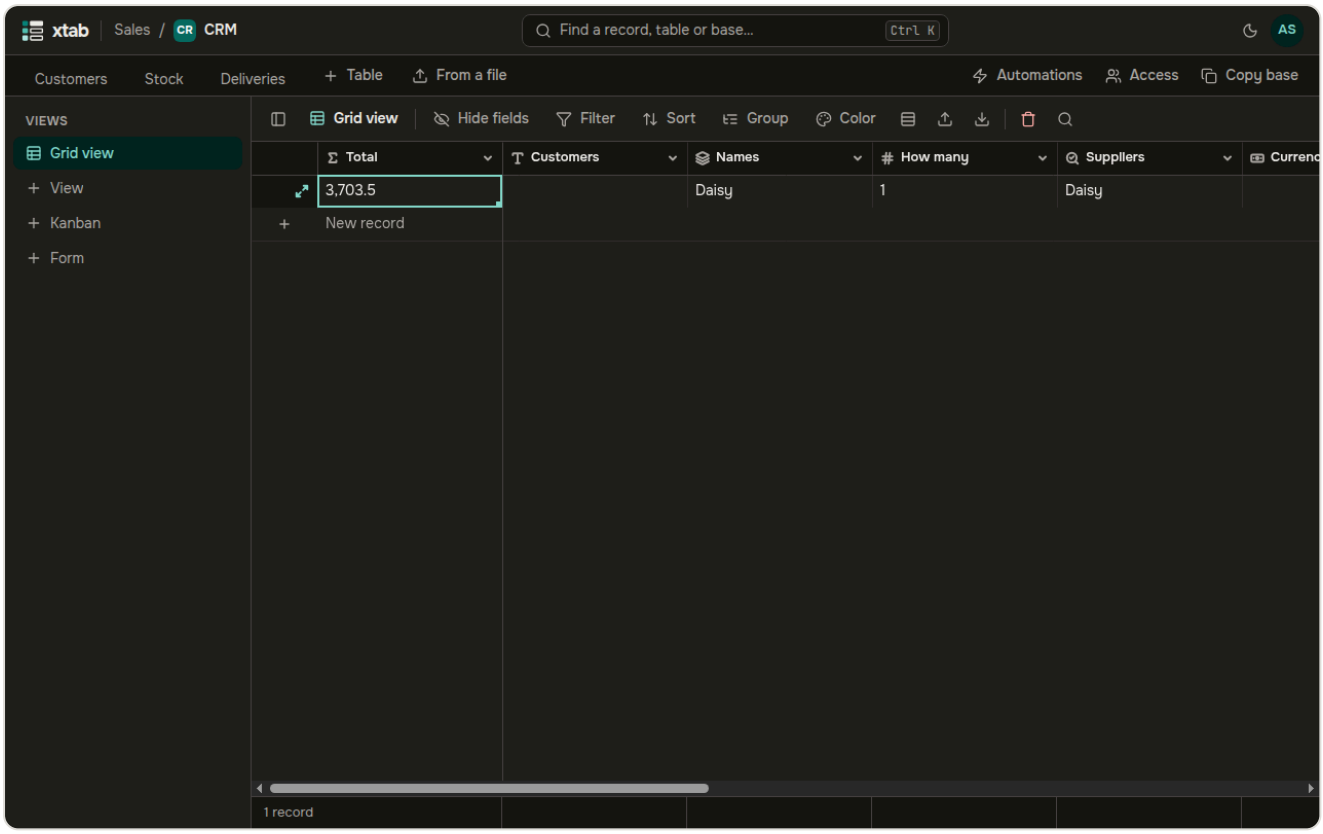
- **Rollup** computes one value over the linked records. Choose the **Link field** and the **Field of the linked table**, then enter an **Expression**. `values` in it stands for the values of the field in the linked records:

- `SUM(values)` — the sum;
- `MAX(values)` — the largest value, dates included;
- `AND(values)` — for checkboxes;
- `ARRAYJOIN(values)` — all values separated by commas.

Only the linked records where limits the rollup to the matching records; its conditions work the same way as in a filter.



The form of a rollup

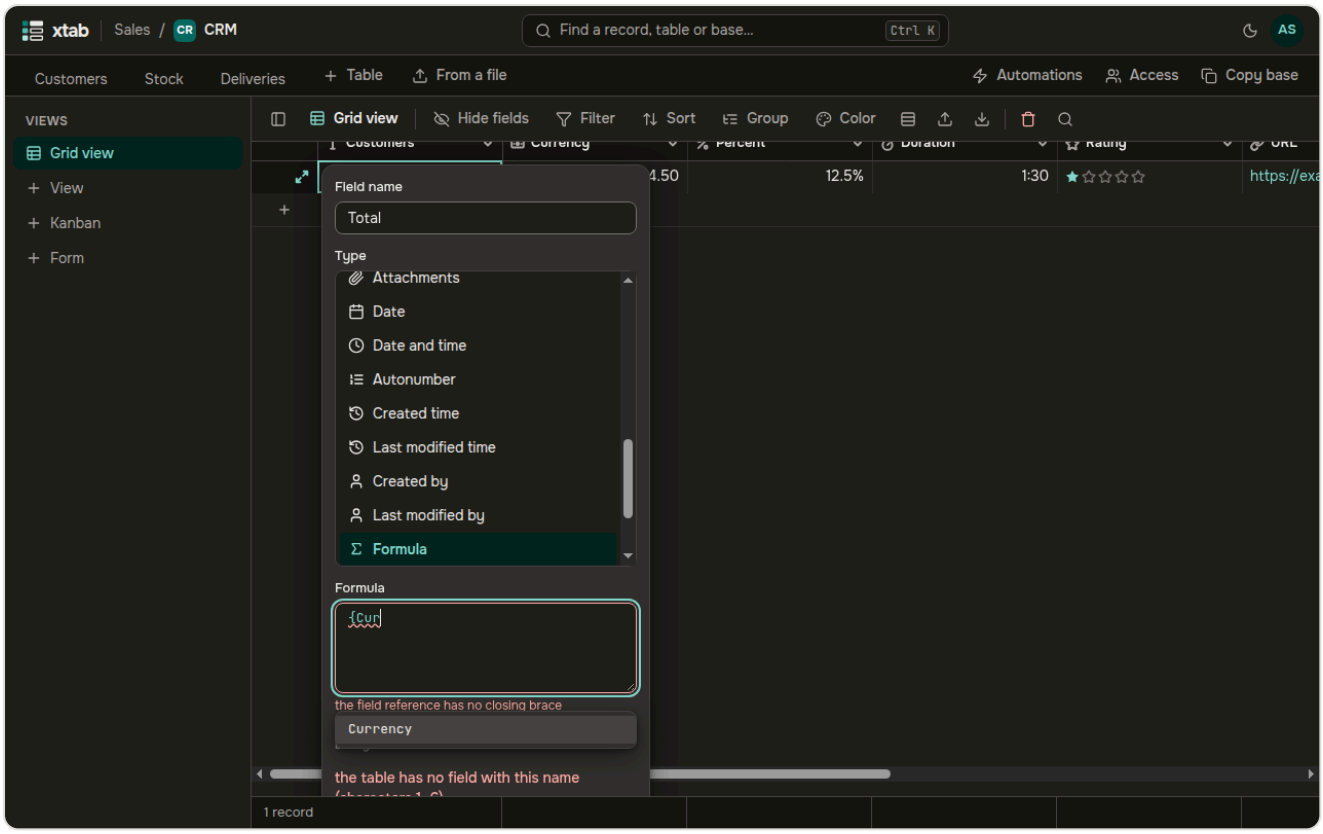


A rollup in the table

Formulas

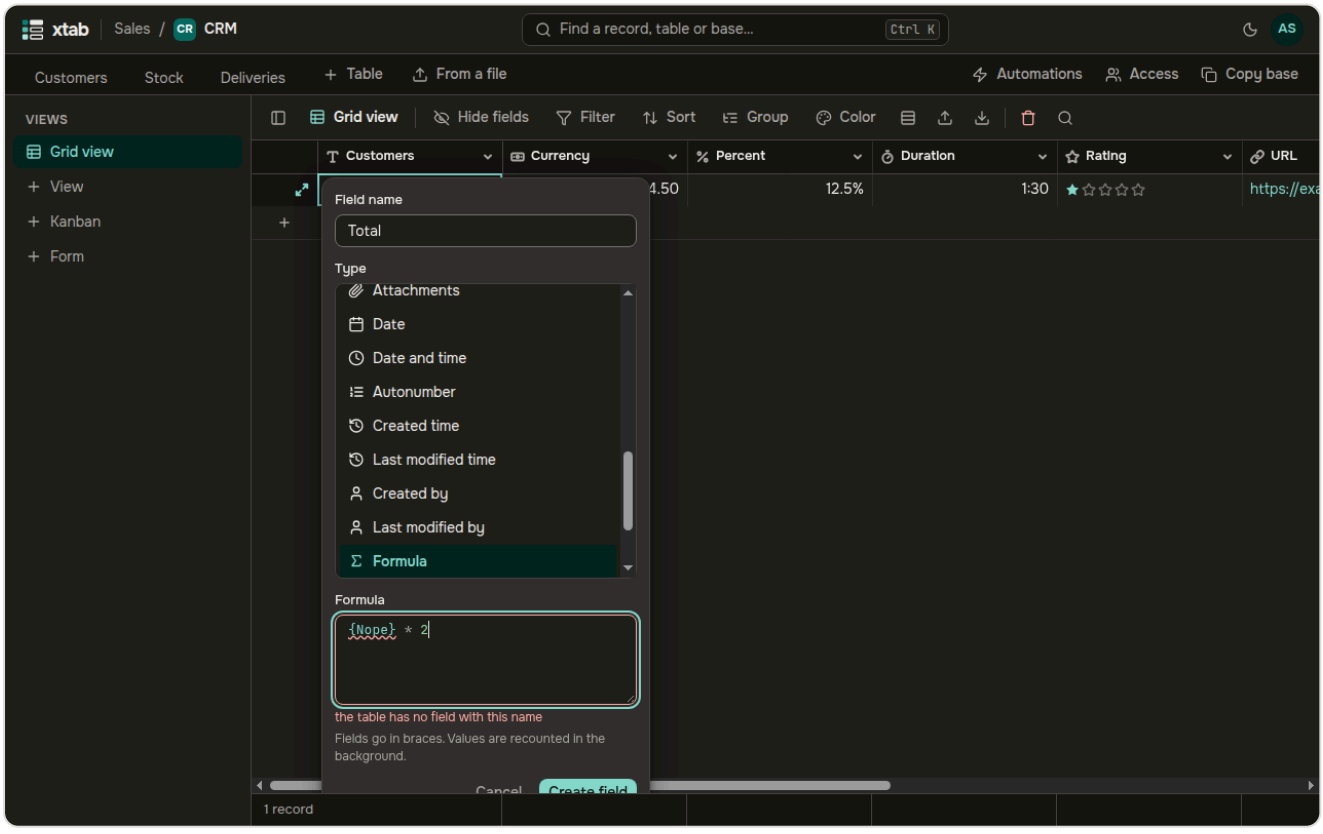
A **Formula** field computes a value from other fields of the record, for example `{Price} * {Quantity}`.

1. Add a field of type **Formula** and type the formula. Field names go in braces.
2. After `{` xtab offers the fields, and as you start typing a function name it offers the functions. Choose one with the arrow keys and press Enter.



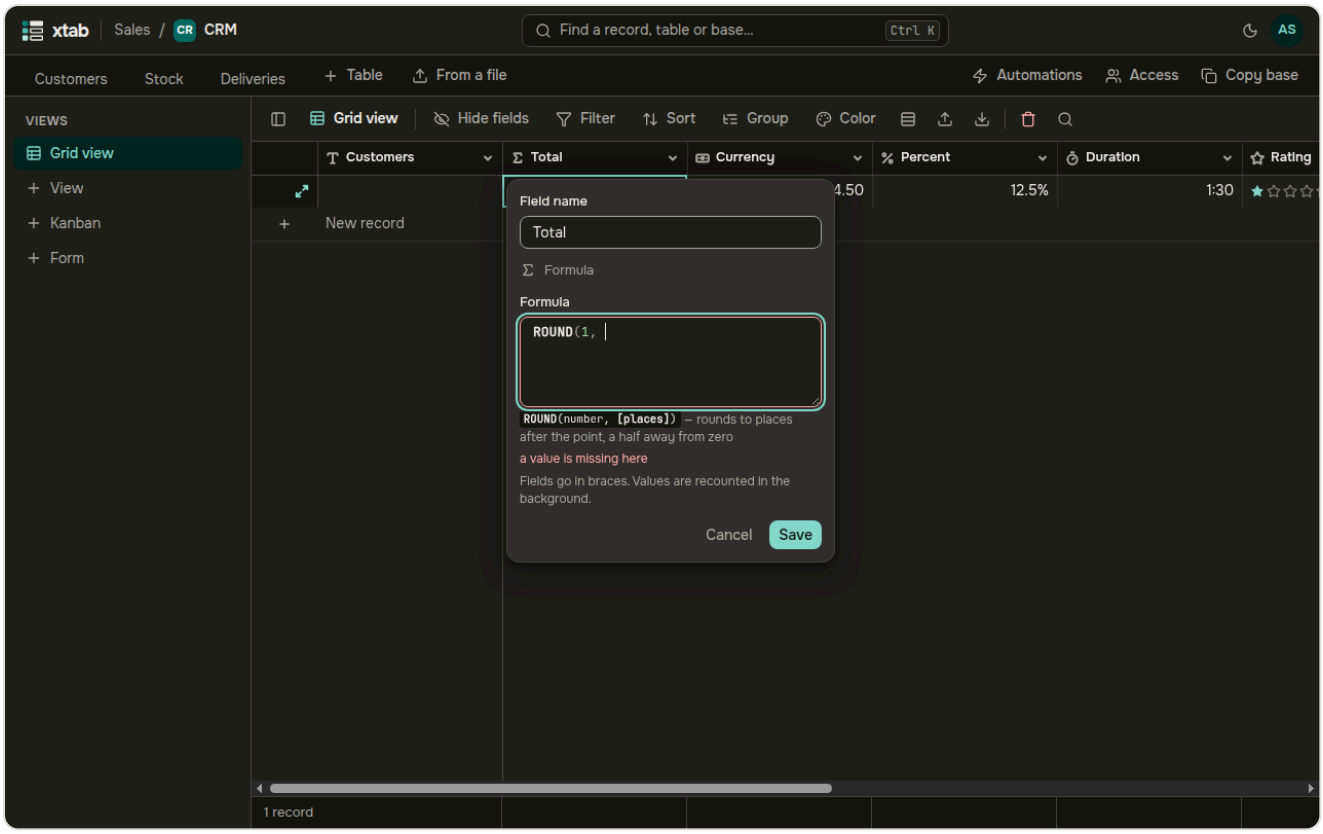
Field suggestions while typing a formula

1. A mistake is underlined at once, and the text below the formula says what is wrong.



A mistake in a formula

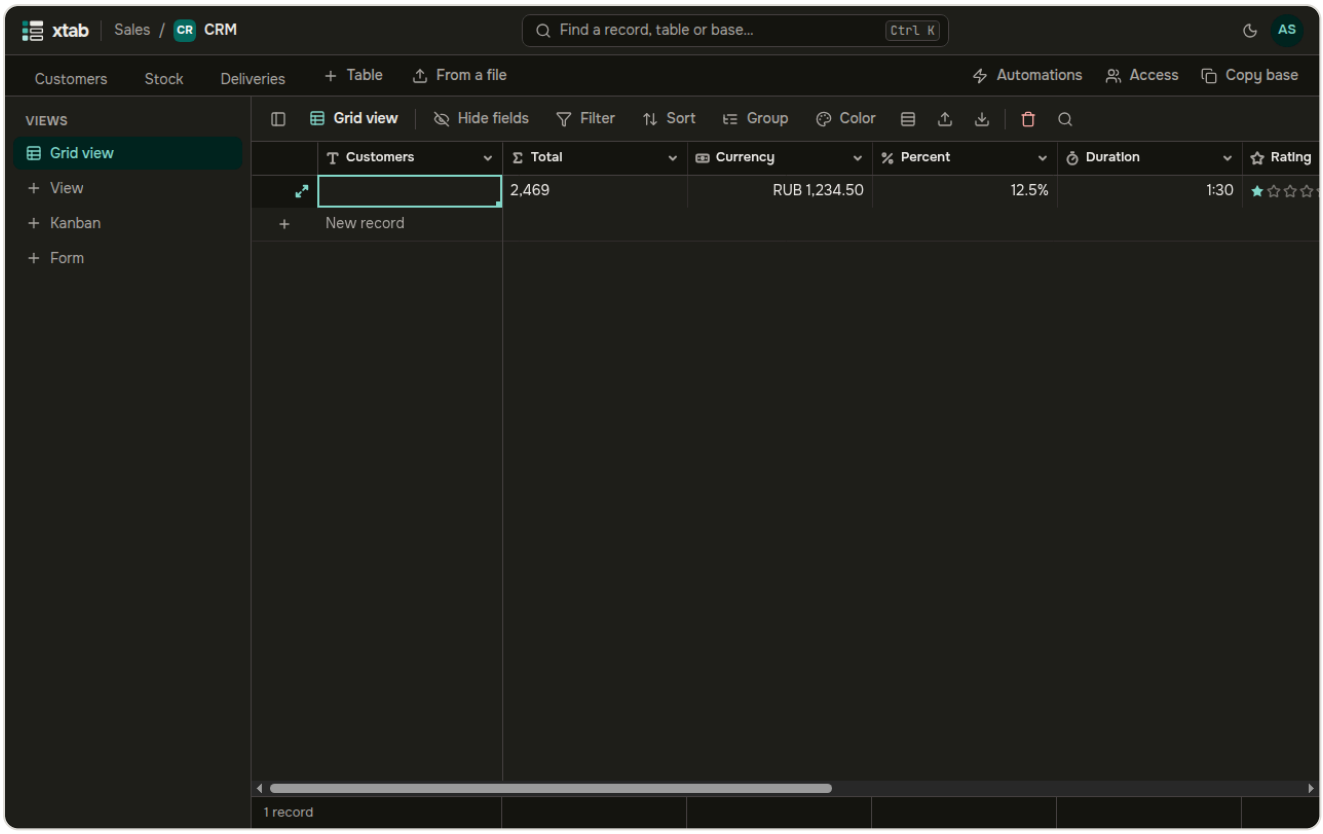
1. While you type a function, the text below the formula shows its arguments and what it does.



A hint on the arguments of a function

1. The line **On the selected record:** shows the result on the current record.
2. Click **Create field**.

A formula recounts by itself when the fields it depends on change. In a big table the recount runs in the background, and the values update as it goes.

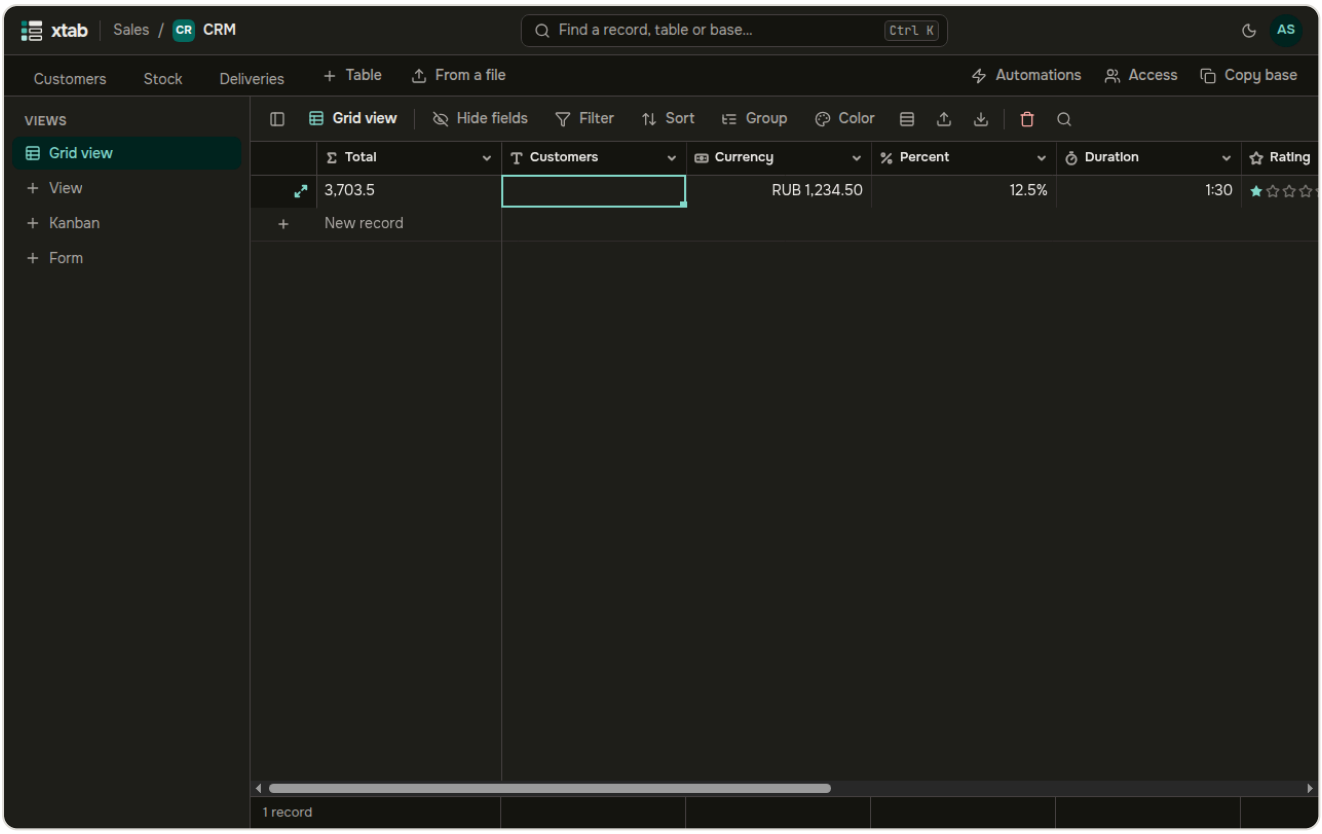


The values of a formula

The functions are the ones you know from Excel and Airtable:

- arithmetic and rounding: `ROUND`, `SUM`, `AVERAGE`;
- conditions: `IF`, `SWITCH`, `AND`, `OR`;
- text: `CONCATENATE`, `LEFT`, `UPPER`, `SUBSTITUTE`;
- dates in the time zone of your organization: `TODAY`, `DATEADD`, `DATETIME_DIFF`, `DATETIME_FORMAT`, `WORKDAY`;
- lists: `ARRAYJOIN`, `ARRAYUNIQUE`;
- regular expressions: `REGEX_MATCH`.

You can filter, sort, group and summarize by the result of a formula. A formula can also be the primary field, so that records are named by its value.

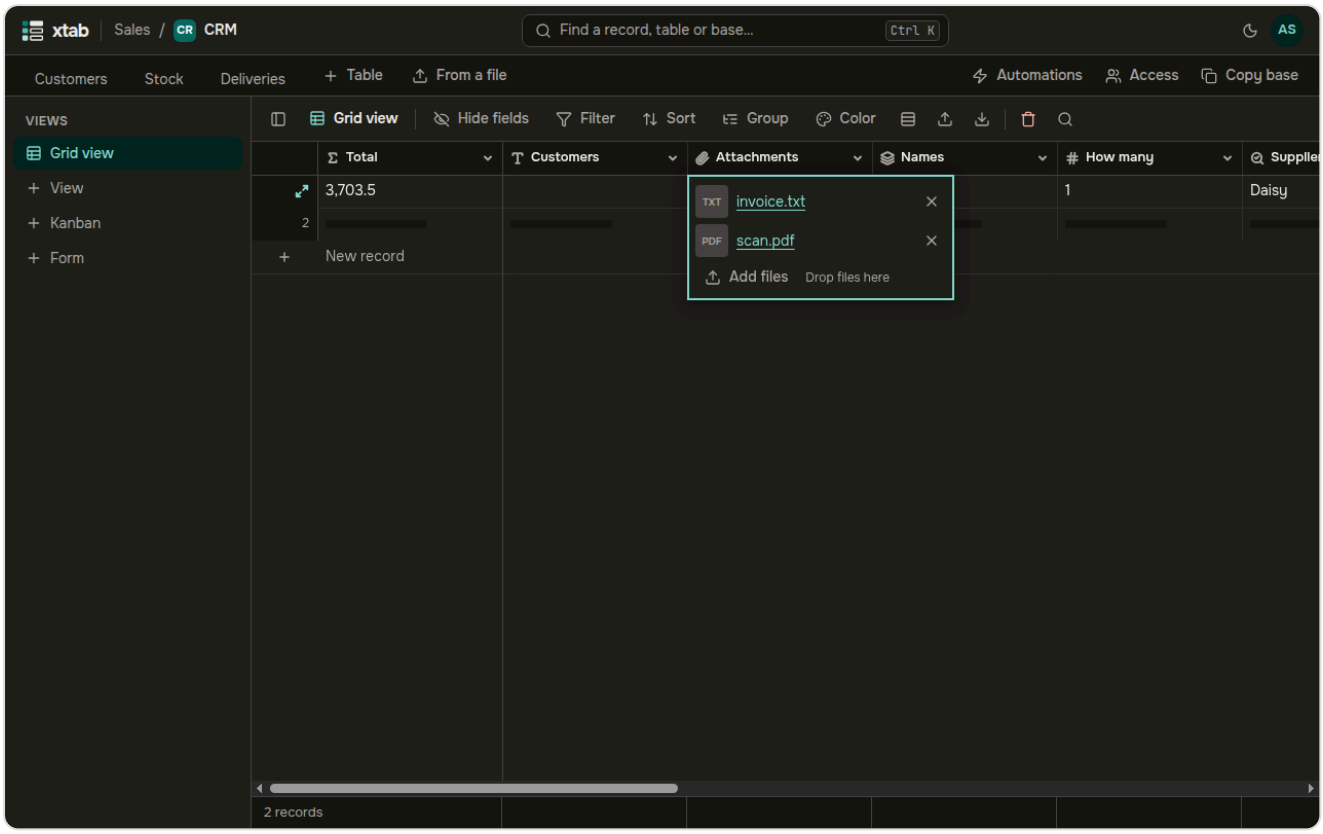


A formula as the primary field

Attachments

An **Attachments** field holds files: contracts, scans, photos.

- **Add files:** select the cell and press Enter, then click **Add files**, or drop the files onto the cell's window. A cell holds up to 100 files.
- **Open a file:** click its name.
- Images, video and sound open in a new tab.
- A PDF opens in a viewer right inside xtab.
- Other files are downloaded.
- **Remove a file:** click the cross to the right of its name. If you removed a file by mistake, undo (Ctrl+Z) and it comes back.



Files in a cell

Images get thumbnails, which show right in the table. When a photo is uploaded, xtab removes the information about where it was taken, the camera and the author.

In the PDF viewer:

- scroll to turn the pages;
- the top bar shows the number of pages and a **Download** button;
- Esc or the cross closes the viewer.

A password-protected document has to be downloaded to open.

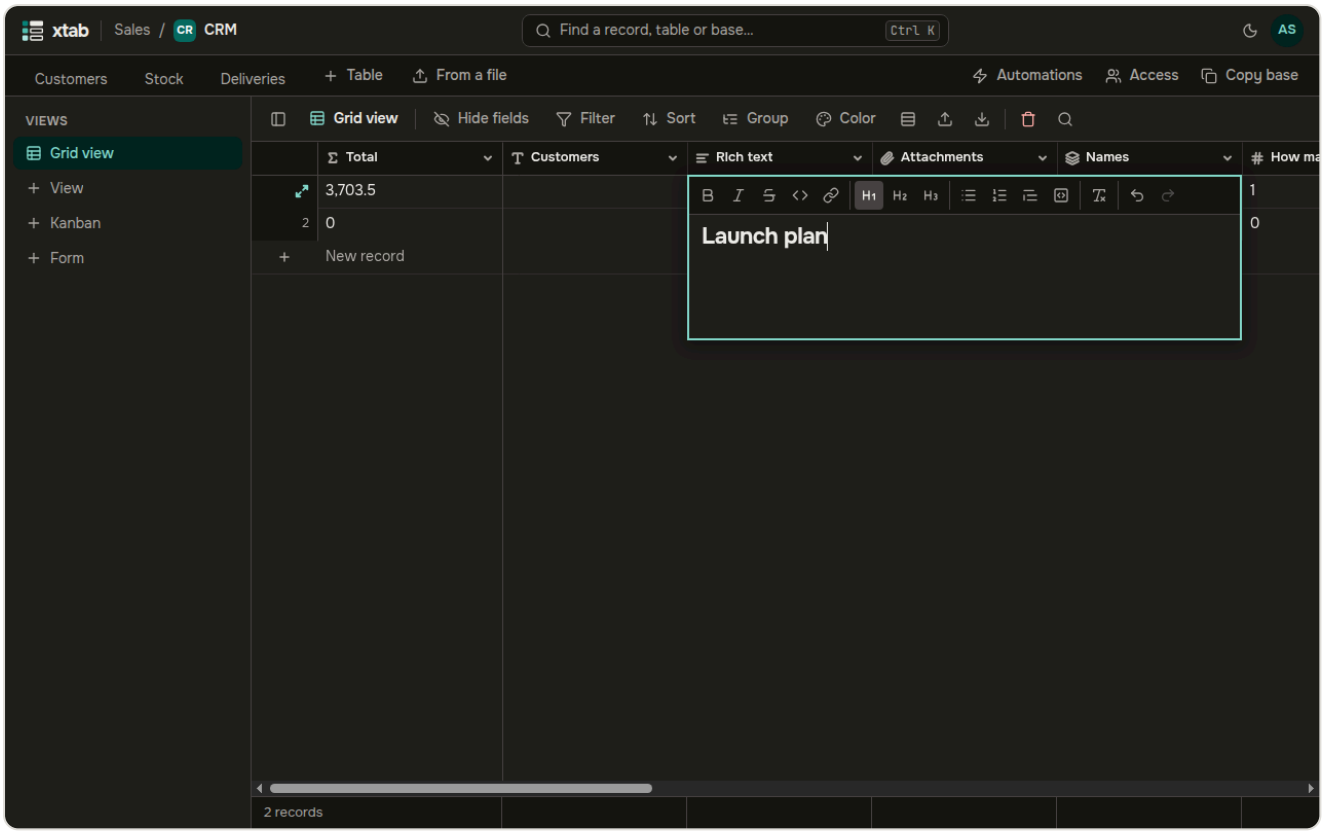


The PDF viewer

Rich text

The field **Long text with formatting** keeps notes, descriptions and instructions with headings, lists, links and quotes.

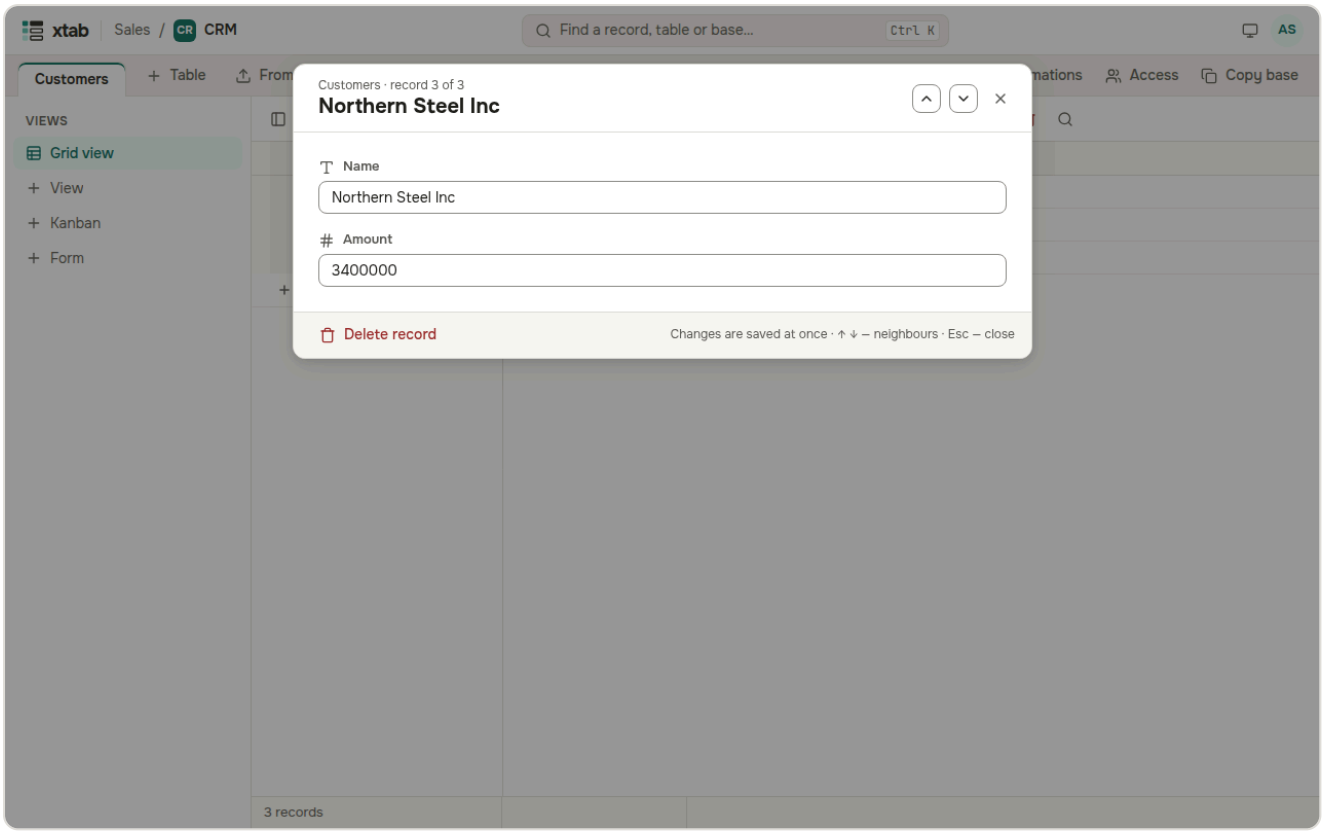
- **Edit:** select the cell and press Enter, or double-click it, to open the editor. The buttons on top: headings, bold, italic, strikethrough, code, link, lists, quote, code block, clear formatting, undo and redo.
- **Save** with Ctrl+Enter or Tab (Tab also moves to the next cell); **cancel the edit** with Esc.
- Links go only to `http://`, `https://` and `mailto:` addresses.
- Text from Word, a browser or mail is pasted with its headings, lists and links; other formatting is dropped.
- The table shows the start of the text without formatting, the whole of it is in the record window.
- Search, filters and formulas work with the text without formatting; on export the field is written as Markdown.



The editor of rich text

An expanded record

To see every field of one record at once, select one of its cells and press Space, or click the number of its row on the left.

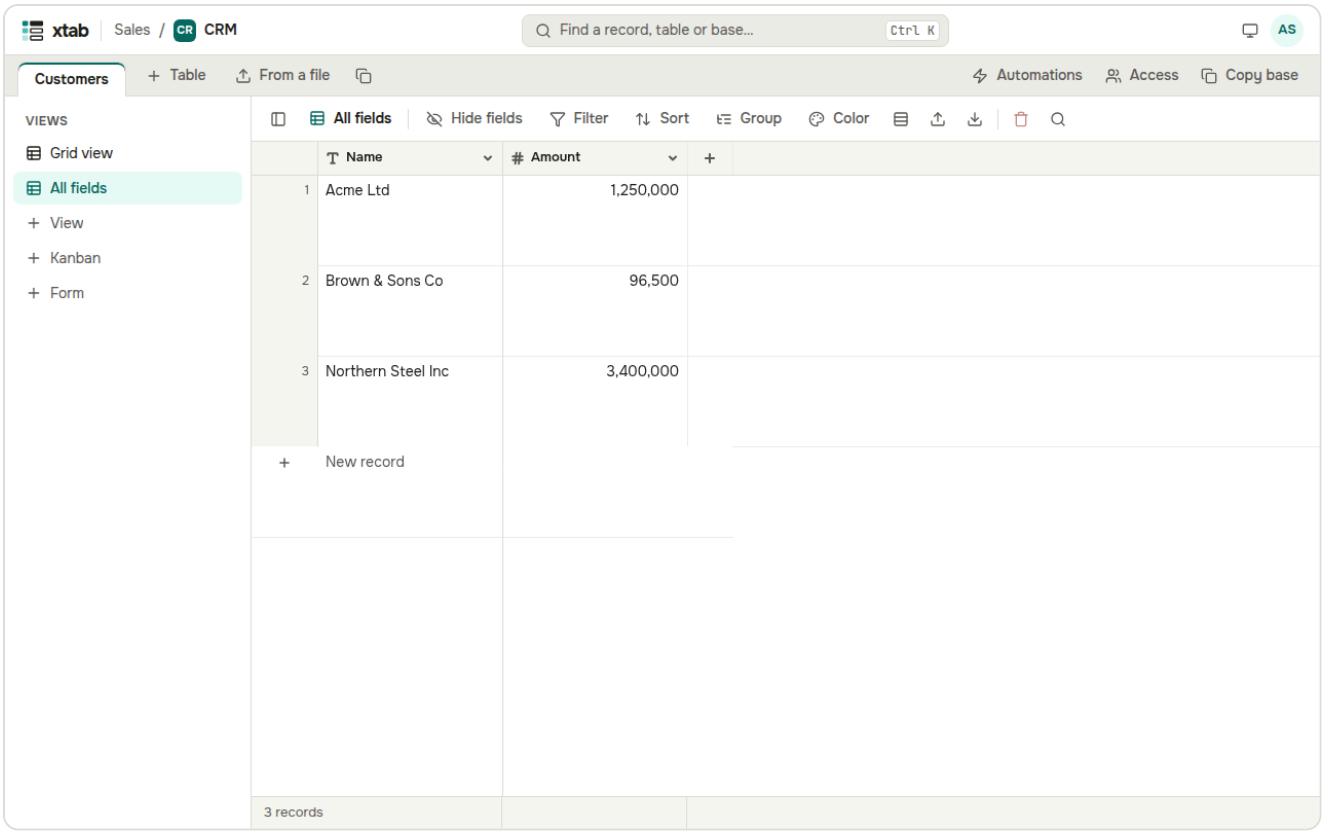


An expanded record

- Change any field: the value is saved as soon as you leave the field or choose an option.
- The arrows ↑ and ↓ (or the buttons at the top) open the neighbouring records.
- Esc or the cross closes the window.

Views

A view is a way of looking at a table: which fields are visible, in what order and how wide the columns are, which records are picked and how they are sorted, grouped and coloured. A table can have many views; they share the data. The list of views is to the left of the table; the panel button at the start of the bar above the table hides and shows it.



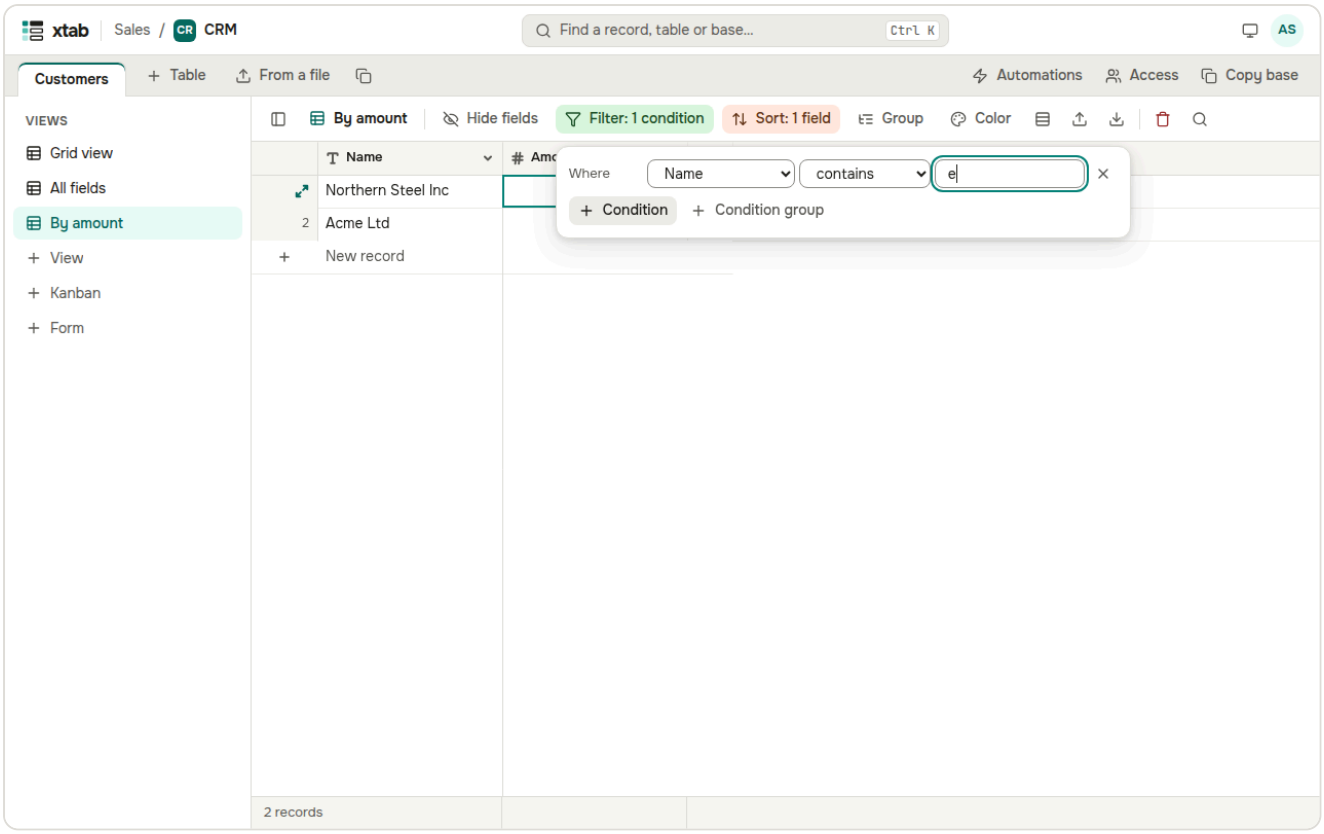
A view with tall rows

- **New view:** click **+ View** in the list on the left, enter a name and press Enter. A new view shows every field.
- **Rename, duplicate, delete:** point at a view in the list and click the pencil, the copy icon or the bin. The last view of a table cannot be deleted.
- **Hide fields:** click **Hide fields** above the table and switch off the fields you do not need; **Hide all** and **Show all** do it at once.
- **Row height:** click the rows icon above the table and choose **Short**, **Medium** or **Tall**.
- **Column width:** drag the right edge of the header of a column.

Every view remembers its own settings. Everyone who opens a view sees it the same way.

Filter

A filter keeps only the matching records in a view. Click **Filter** above the table, then **+ Condition**: choose a field, a condition (for example «contains», «greater than», «today») and a value. Several conditions are joined by «and» or «or»; **+ Condition group** puts conditions in brackets.



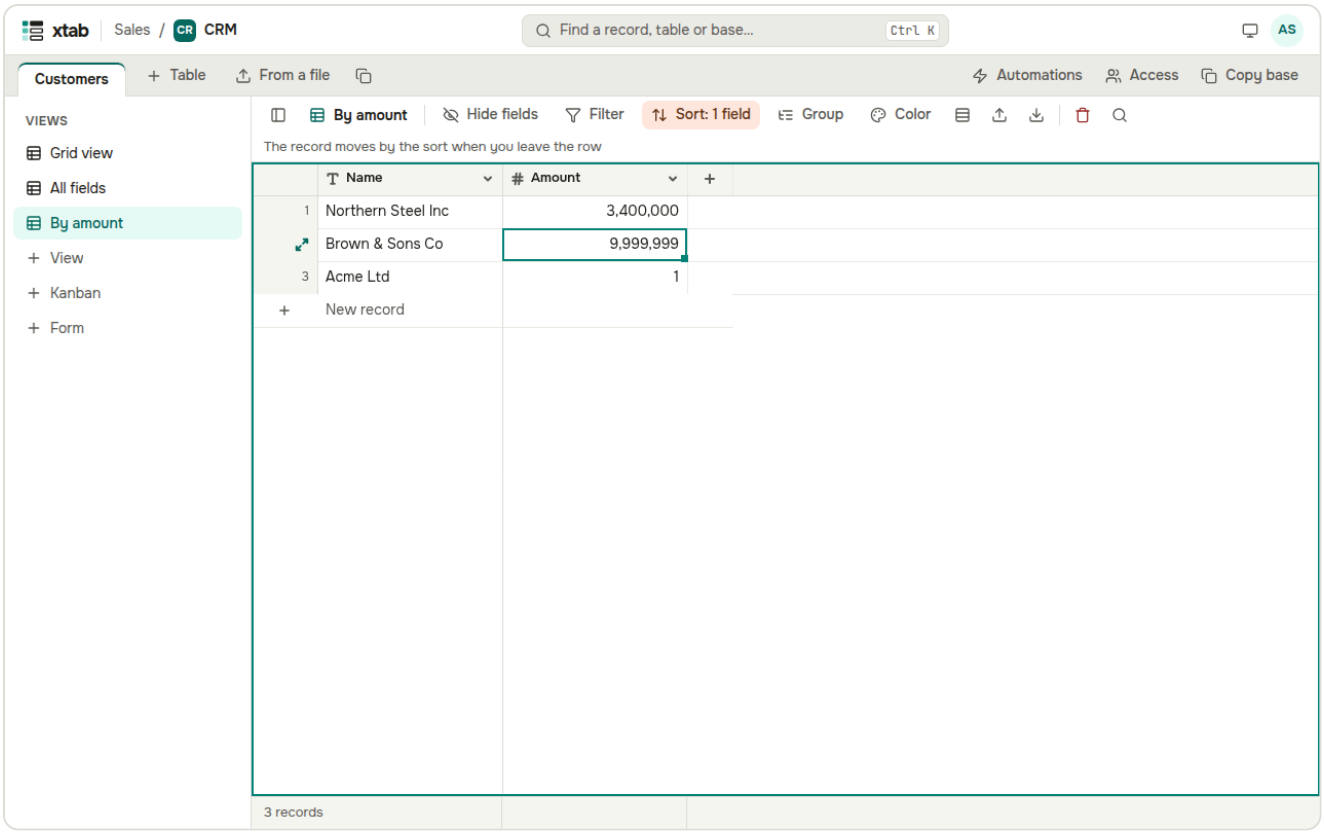
A filter by name

The button lights up and shows the number of conditions. To remove a condition, click the cross to its right.

Sort

Click **Sort** above the table, then **Add sort**, choose a field and a direction. The second and further sorts order the records with equal values of the first one. Without a sort, records come in manual order — the order you added them in.

If you change a value and the record should move by the sort or disappear by the filter, it stays in place until you leave the row; a hint above the table says so.

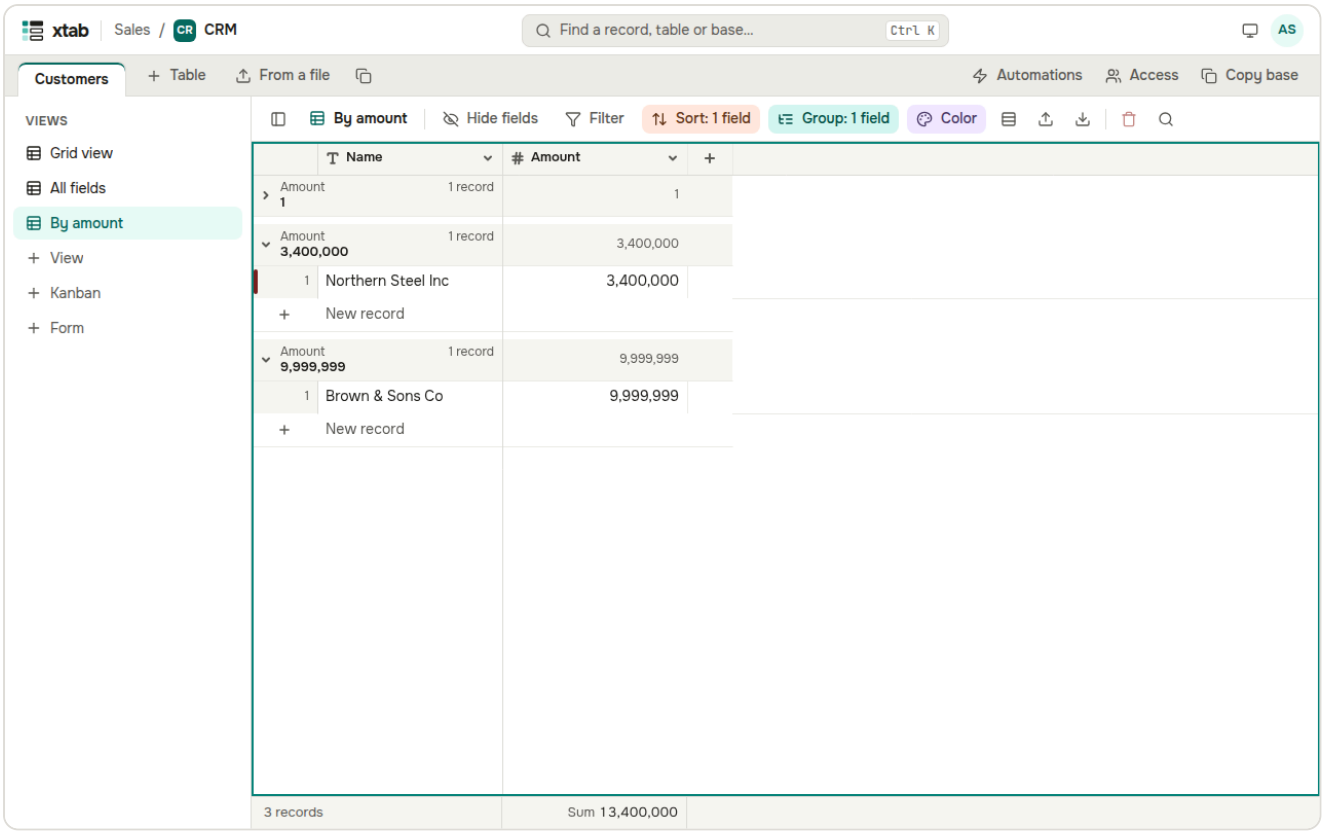


A record stays in place until you leave the row

If you have no right to change the view, you can still set a filter and a sort: only you see them, and they reset when the page reloads. The bar above the table then shows **Temporary filter and sort** with a **Reset** button.

Grouping

Click **Group** above the table, then **Add grouping** and choose a field: records with the same value gather in a group with a header and the number of records. You can group by several fields.



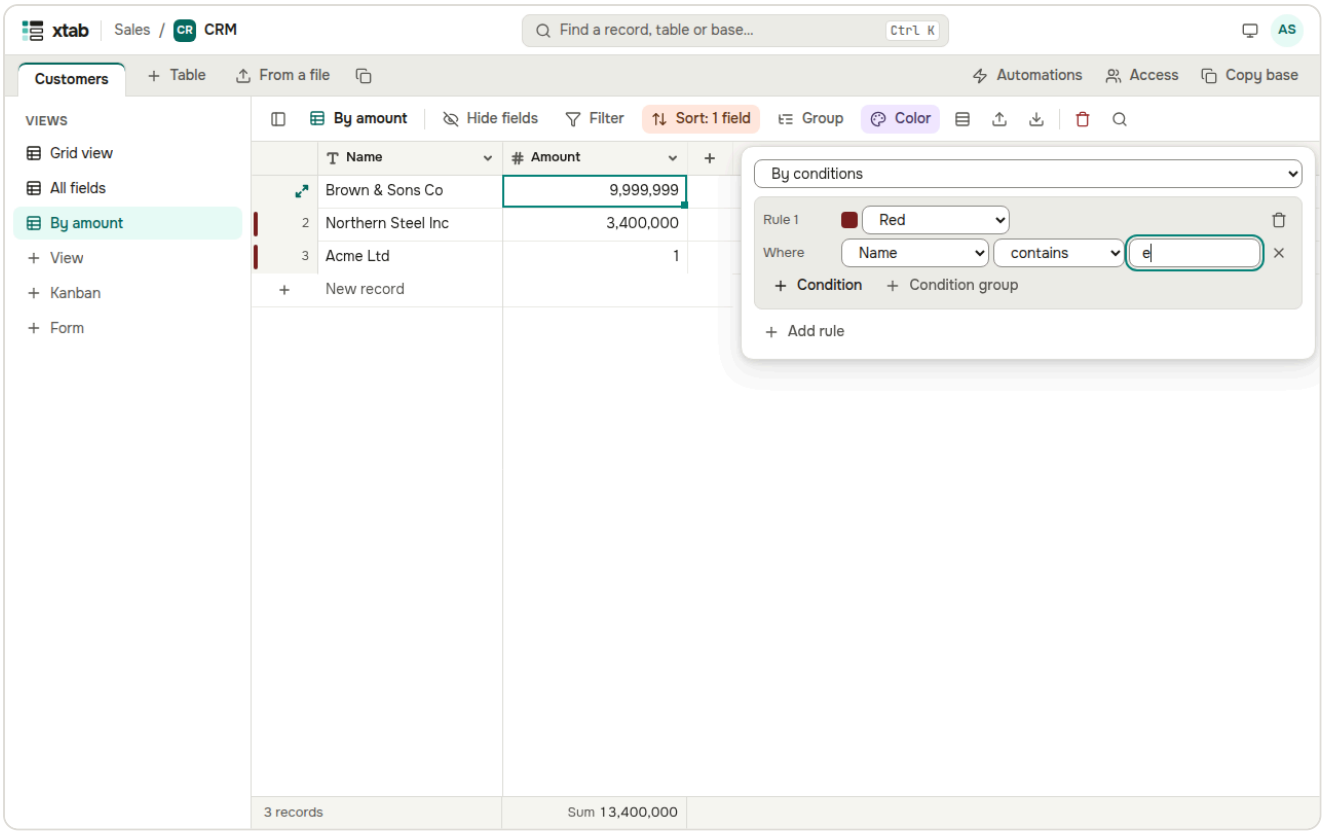
Records grouped by amount

- Click the arrow in the header of a group to collapse or expand it; **Collapse all** and **Expand all** are in the grouping panel.
- The row **New record** at the bottom of a group adds a record with its value already set.

Record colours

Click **Color** above the table and choose how to colour records:

- **By a single select field** — a stripe to the left of a record takes the colour of its option;
- **By conditions** — set a rule: a colour and conditions, as in a filter. **Add rule** adds another one; a record takes the colour of the first rule it meets.



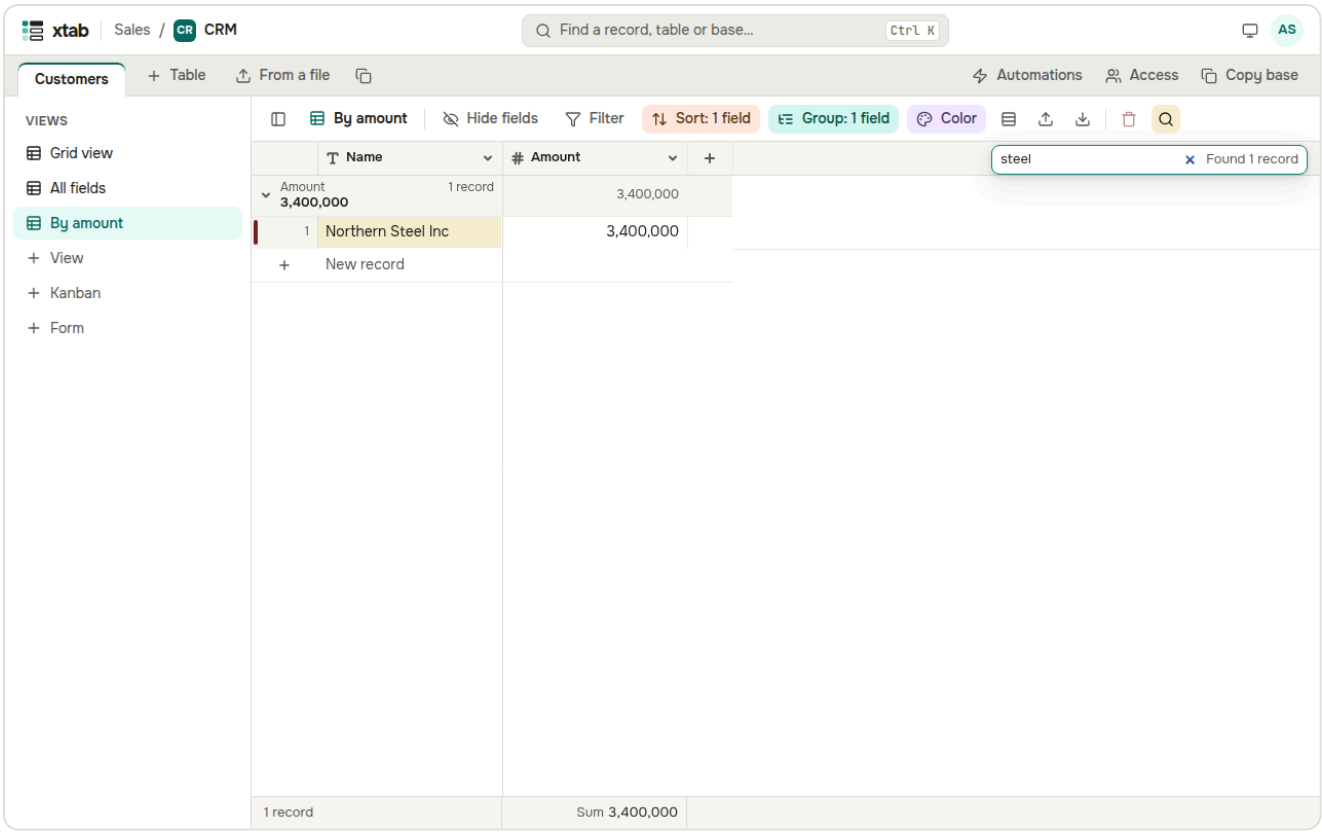
A colour rule

Summaries under columns

In the row at the bottom of the table, click under a column and choose a function: sum, average, minimum, maximum, the number of filled or empty, unique, the earliest or latest date and others. A summary counts the records of the view, with its filter.

Searching a view

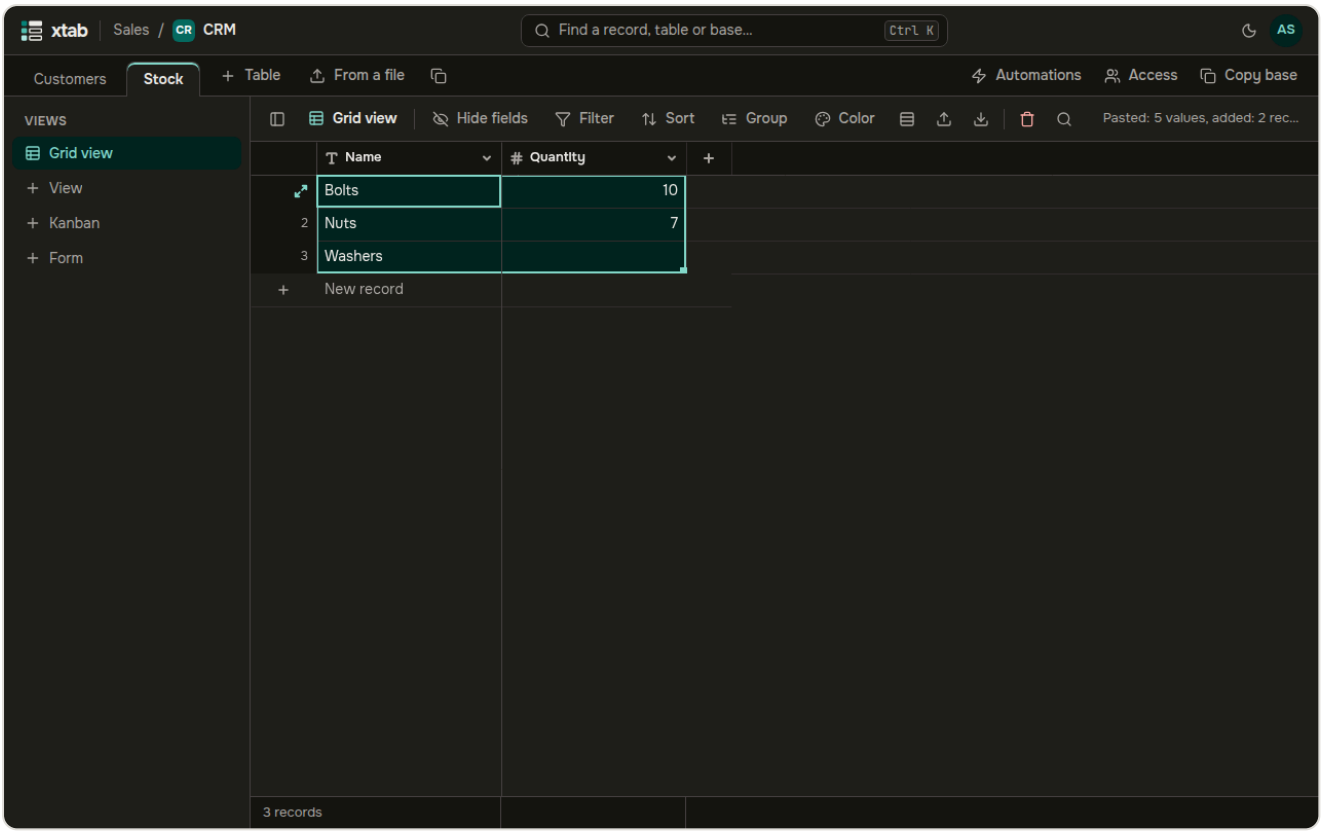
Press Ctrl+F (⌘F on a Mac) or click the magnifier above the table and type the text. The view keeps the records with that text, the matches are highlighted, and the number of records found is shown next to the search box. The cross clears the search.



Searching a view

Selecting, copying and pasting

- **Select a range:** drag the mouse over cells or press the arrows with Shift; Ctrl+A selects every cell of the view.
- **Copy and paste:** Ctrl+C, Ctrl+X and Ctrl+V — also from Excel and Google Sheets and back. If you paste more rows than there are records below, the missing records are added. The bar above the table shows how many values were pasted and which did not fit the fields.
- **Fill down:** drag the small square in the bottom right corner of the selection or press Ctrl+D — the values of the top row are copied down.
- **Clear cells:** Delete.
- **Range menu:** right-click the selection — copy, cut, fill down, clear cells, delete records.



A pasted range

Undo

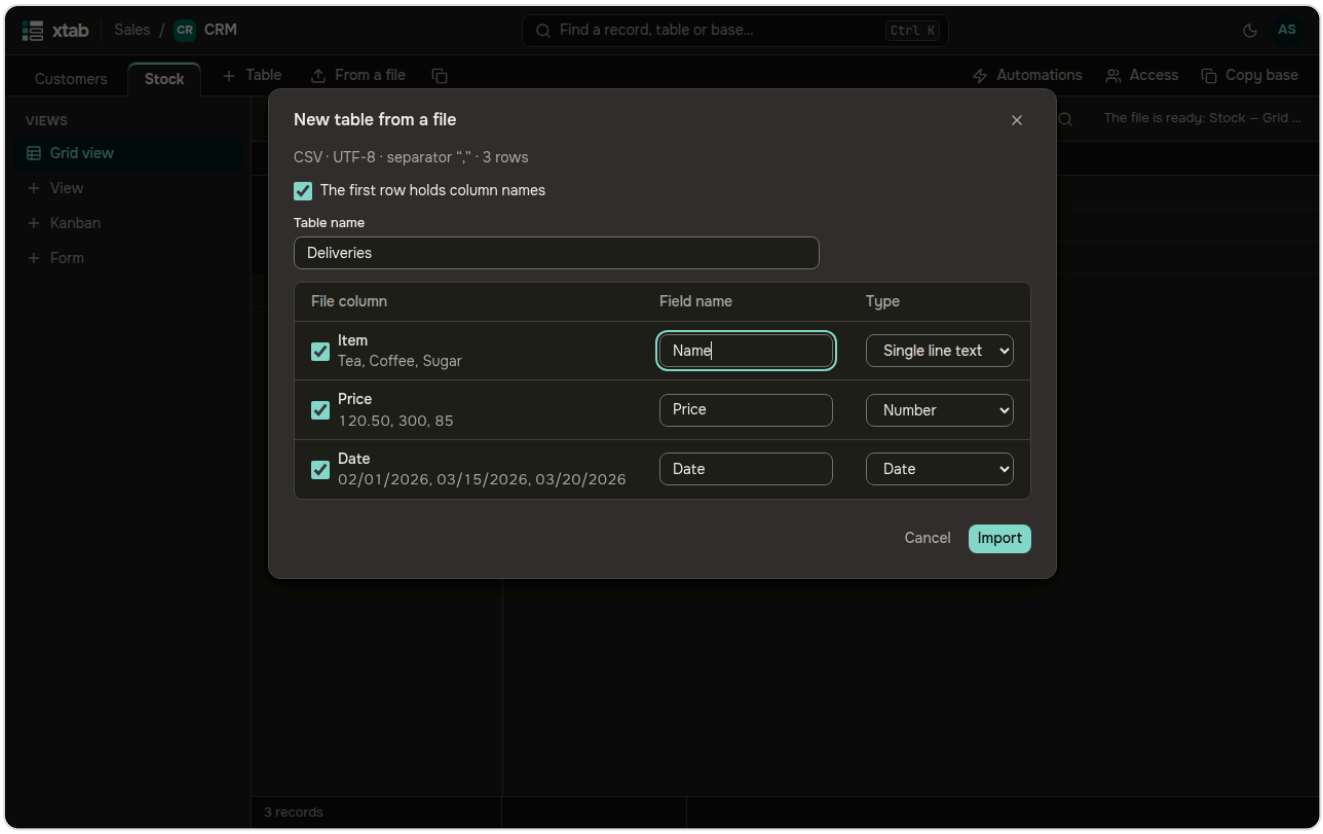
Ctrl+Z undoes the last action in a table: an edit, a paste, clearing, a new or deleted record. Ctrl+Shift+Z or Ctrl+Y redoes it. If another person changed a value after you, their edit is kept.

Import from CSV and Excel

CSV and XLSX files up to 50 MB fit; xtab detects the encoding and separator of CSV itself.

- **New table from a file:** click **From a file** to the right of the table tabs.
- **Records into this table:** click the up-arrow icon above the table.

Drop a file into the window or click **Choose a file**. xtab shows the columns of the file with sample values and suggests a field and a type for each. Clear the checkbox of a column you do not need, correct the names and types and click **Import**.

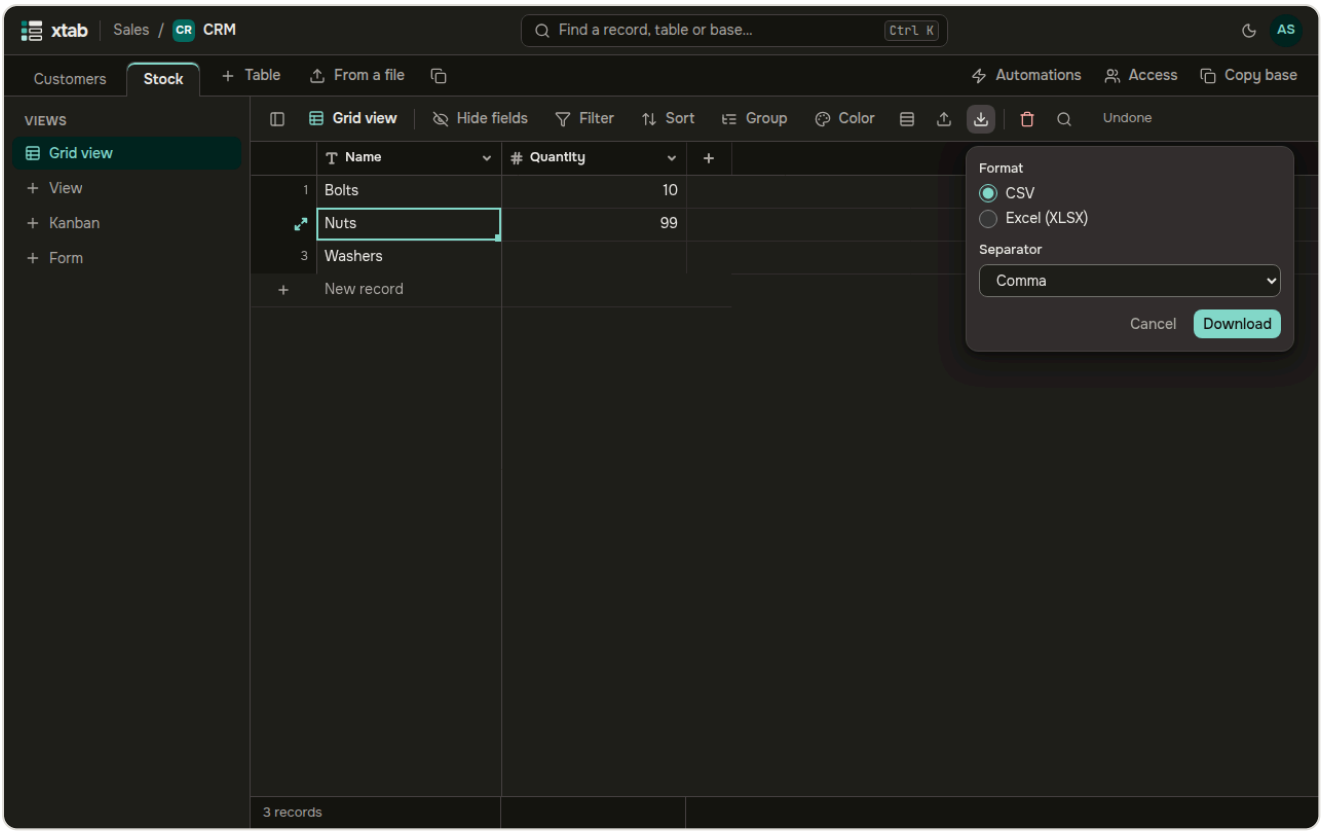


New table from a file

- You may close the window — the import goes on; its progress shows above the table.
- If many values do not fit the fields, the import stops and shows examples: **Import anyway** or **Do not import**. **Download the report** gives a file with every row that did not fit.
- **Delete the imported records** — within a day after the import: removes the records it added. Records changed since then can be kept.

Export to CSV and Excel

Click the down-arrow icon above the table, choose a format — **CSV** or **Excel (XLSX)** — and for CSV a separator, then **Download**. The file gets the records and fields of the view, with its filter and sort. If there are more than 1000 records, xtab asks for your password again.

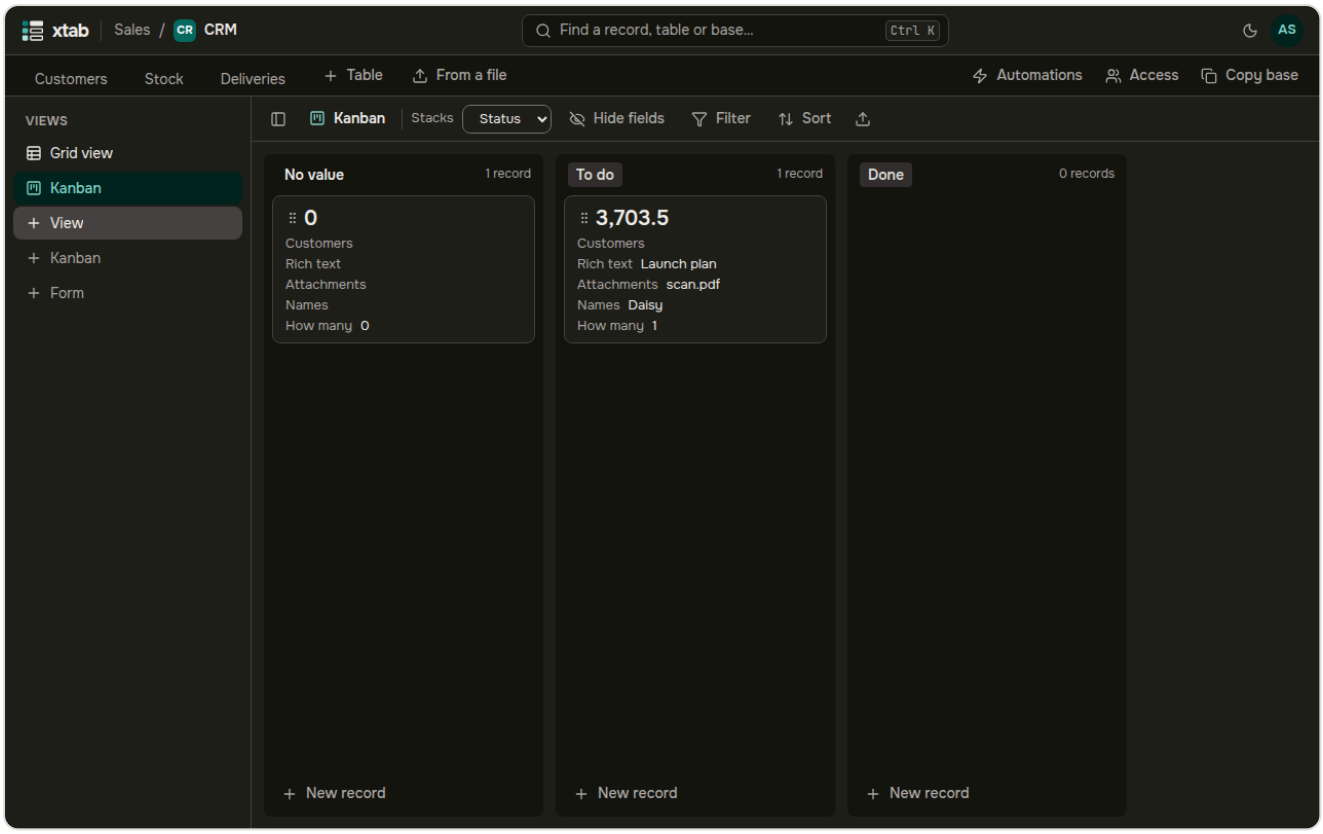


Exporting a view

Kanban

A kanban shows records as cards in stacks, by a single select or a user field. It suits tasks, requests and deals moving through stages.

- **Create:** click **+ Kanban** in the list of views on the left, type a name and press Enter, then choose the field in the list **Stacks**.
- There is a stack for every option of the field and one for **No value**; the header of a stack shows the number of its cards.
- A card shows the primary field and the next fields of the table; hide the ones you do not need with **Hide fields** above the kanban. Filter and sort work as in the table.
- **Move a card:** drag it with the mouse or a finger to another stack or another place, and the value of the field changes by itself. With the keyboard, select the card and press Alt with an arrow.
- **Open the record:** click the card or press Enter.
- **New record** at the bottom of a stack creates a record with the value of that stack.

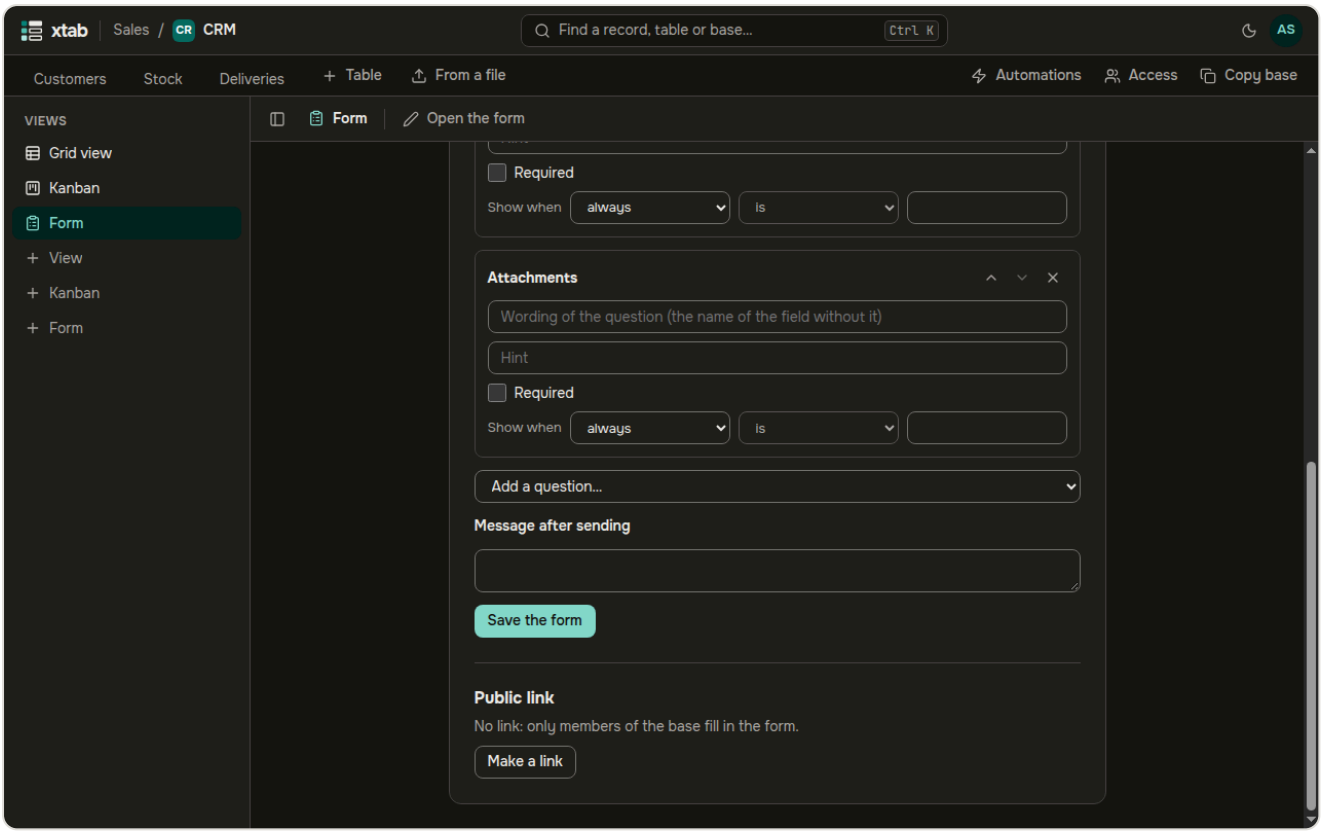


A kanban by status

Forms

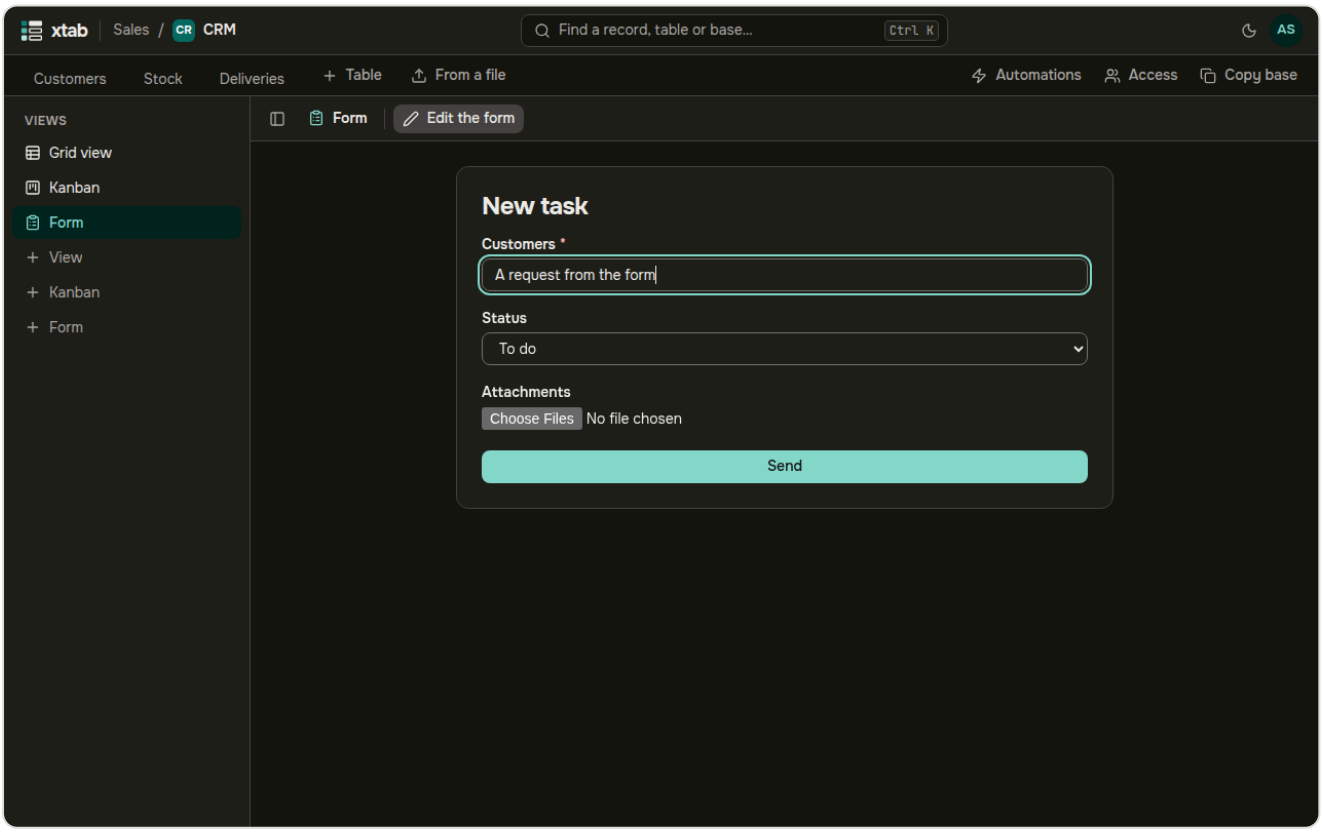
A form collects records into a table: the members of the base fill it in inside xtab, and anyone can fill it in by a public link without signing in.

- **Create:** click **+ Form** in the list of views on the left, type a name and press Enter; the builder opens.
- In the builder set the title, the description and the message after sending. **Add a question...** picks a field of the table. A question can have its own wording (without it the name of the field is shown), a hint, the mark **Required** and a condition **Show when**, so it appears only after a certain answer to an earlier question. **Up**, **Down** and **Remove the question** change the order and the set. Click **Save the form**.
- A form asks fields that are filled in by hand: texts, numbers, selects, checkbox, dates, files and users. Formulas, links and system fields are not asked.



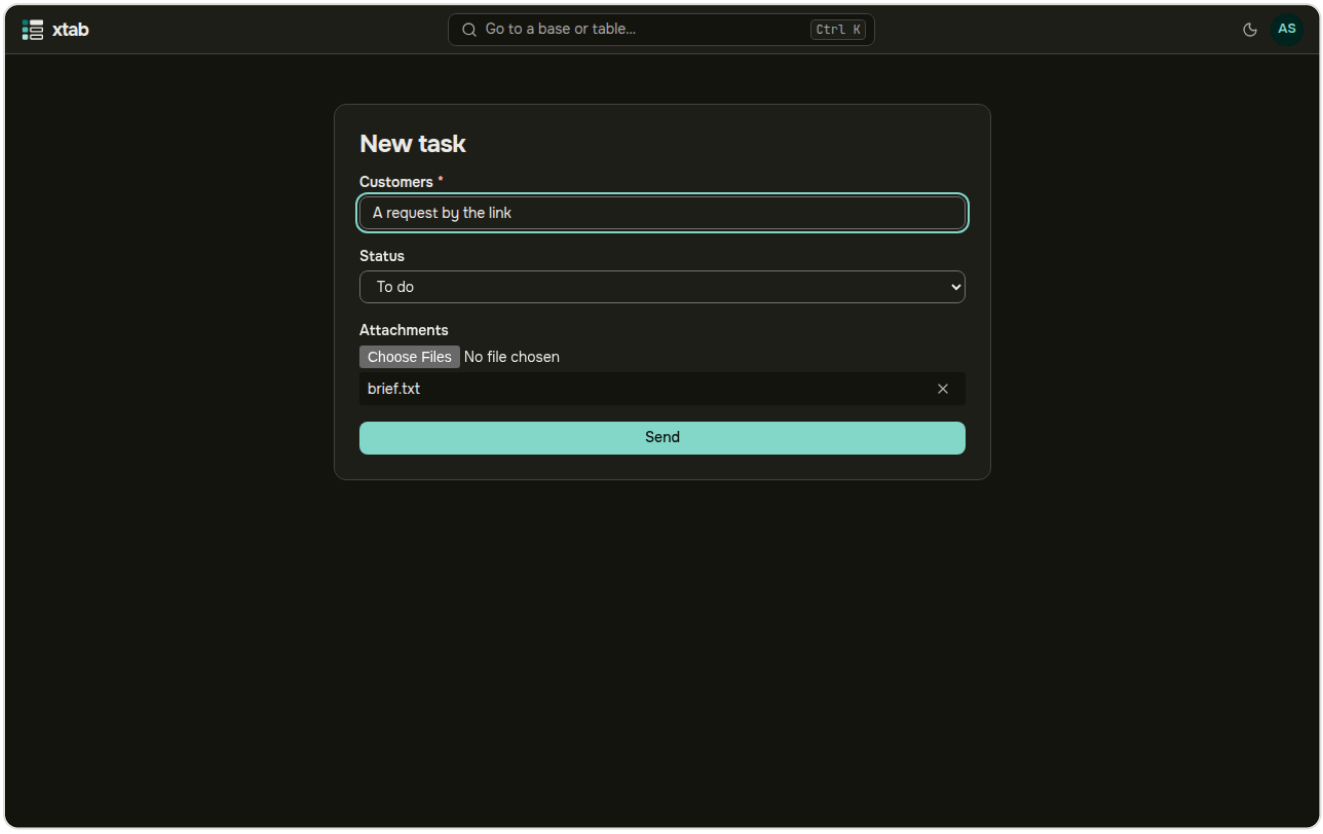
The form builder

- **Open the form** fills it in yourself, **Edit the form** goes back to the builder. After sending, a message and the button **Send another** appear.



A form for the members of the base

- **Public link** is in the builder. **Make a link**: the link is shown once, copy it right away. **Make a new link** replaces the old one, **Revoke the link** turns the form off for everyone who had it. The link is managed by whoever may change the views of the base.
- By the link the form is filled in without signing in. A public form has no questions about people; a question about files takes up to 5 files of up to 10 MB each. Before sending, the browser spends a few seconds proving the form is not filled in by a robot.

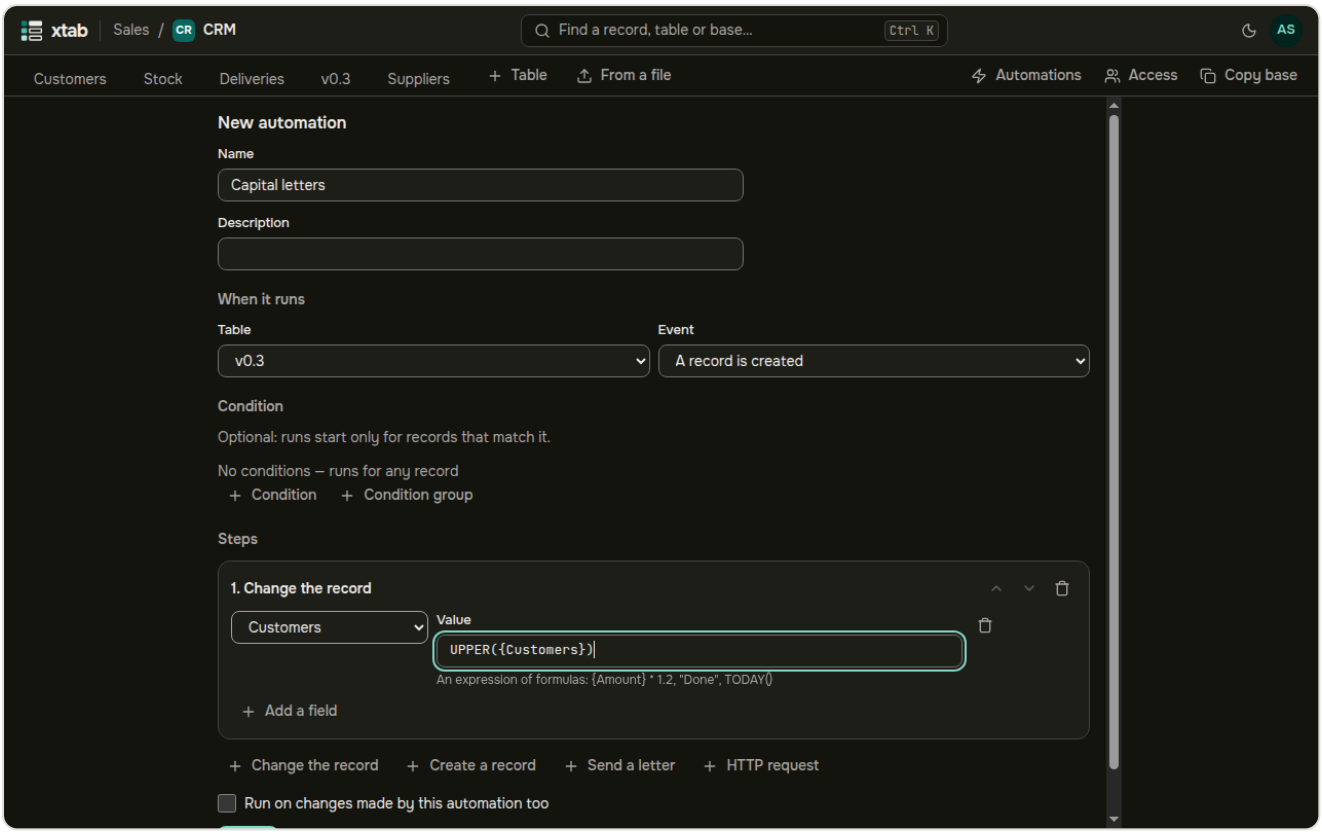


A public form by its link

Automations

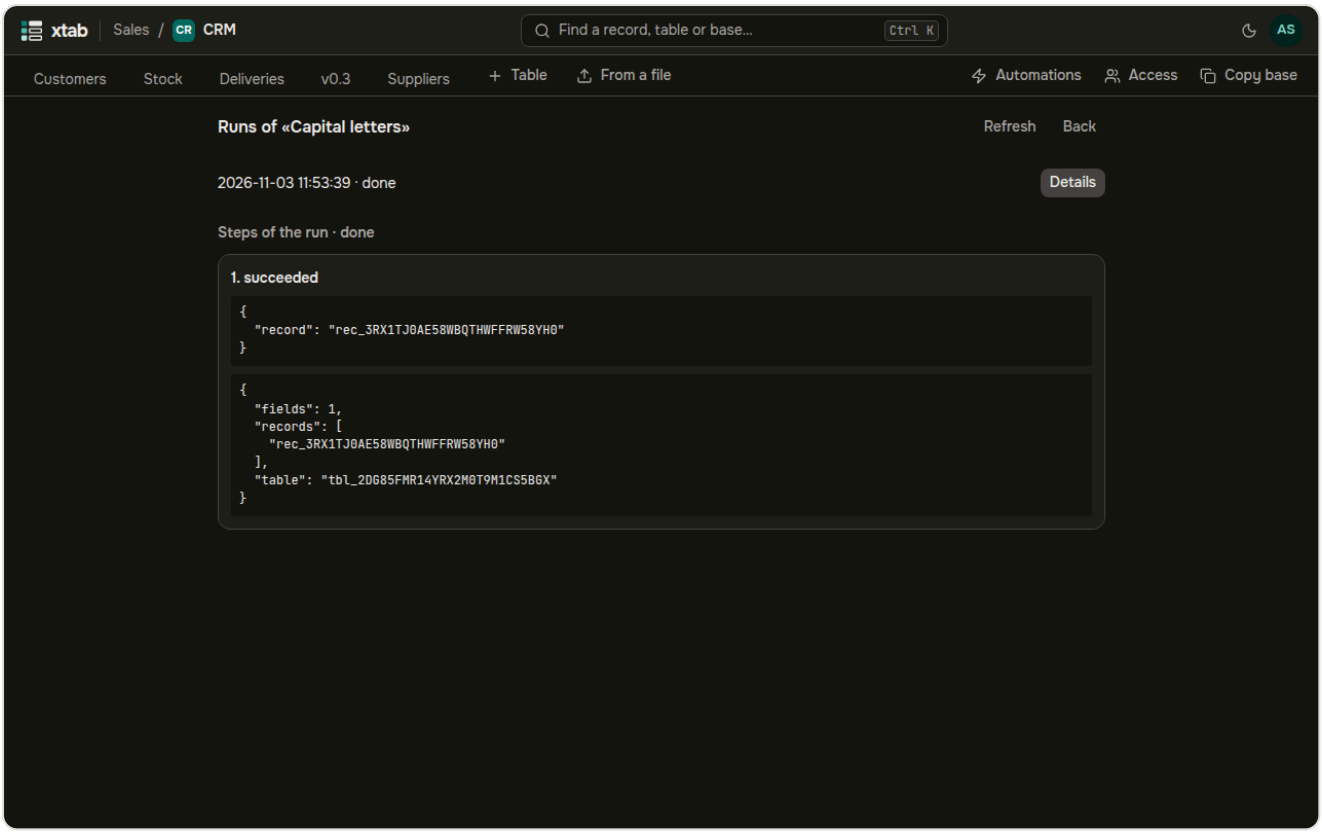
An automation does work by itself: when a record is created, changed, begins to match a condition or comes from a form, it does its steps — changes the record, creates a record in another table, sends a letter or an HTTP request to an external system. Creators of the base make and change automations; the steps run with the rights of the person who made the automation.

- **Open:** the button **Automations** in the row of tables of the base. The list shows each automation, its event, the number of its steps and its state: **On**, **Off** or **Stopped by the system** with the reason.
- **New automation:** give a name, the table and the event. For **A record is changed** tick the fields whose change starts it; for **A form is sent** pick the form. The **Condition** is built as the filter of a view; the event **A record begins to match the condition** needs one.



The editor of an automation: the event, the condition and the step «Change the record»

- **Steps** are added by the buttons under the list of steps and run in order; the arrows change the order, the bin removes a step.
- **Change the record** and **Create a record**: pick a field and write its value as a formula, for example `UPPER({Name})` or `TODAY()`. A mistake in the formula shows under the field at once.
- **Send a letter**: recipients from the e-mail and user fields of the record and addresses separated by commas, a subject and a text with inserts `{{ {Field} }}`. Letters go to members of the organization, to the domains of invitations and to the addresses the administrator allowed on the page **Outgoing addresses**.
- **HTTP request**: the method, the address (its host is written without inserts and must be allowed on the page **Outgoing addresses**), headers, a JSON body with inserts, a signing secret and Basic authentication.
- **Secrets** are keys of external services and passwords for HTTP requests. They are set at the bottom of the form of a saved automation: a value is encrypted and never shown again, only replaced. In a header of a request choose the kind **Secret** and give the name of the secret.
- A new automation is off: click **Turn on**. When more than half of its last runs fail, or its owner no longer has the rights, the system turns it off and writes to the creators of the base.
- **Run log** shows the runs with the result of each step. A failed run can be **Run again**: the steps done are not repeated. When a letter or a request may have arrived but no answer came, the run's outcome is **outcome unknown**: check the receiver and click **Run again** or **Mark done**. The log keeps runs for 30 days.



The run log with the steps of a run

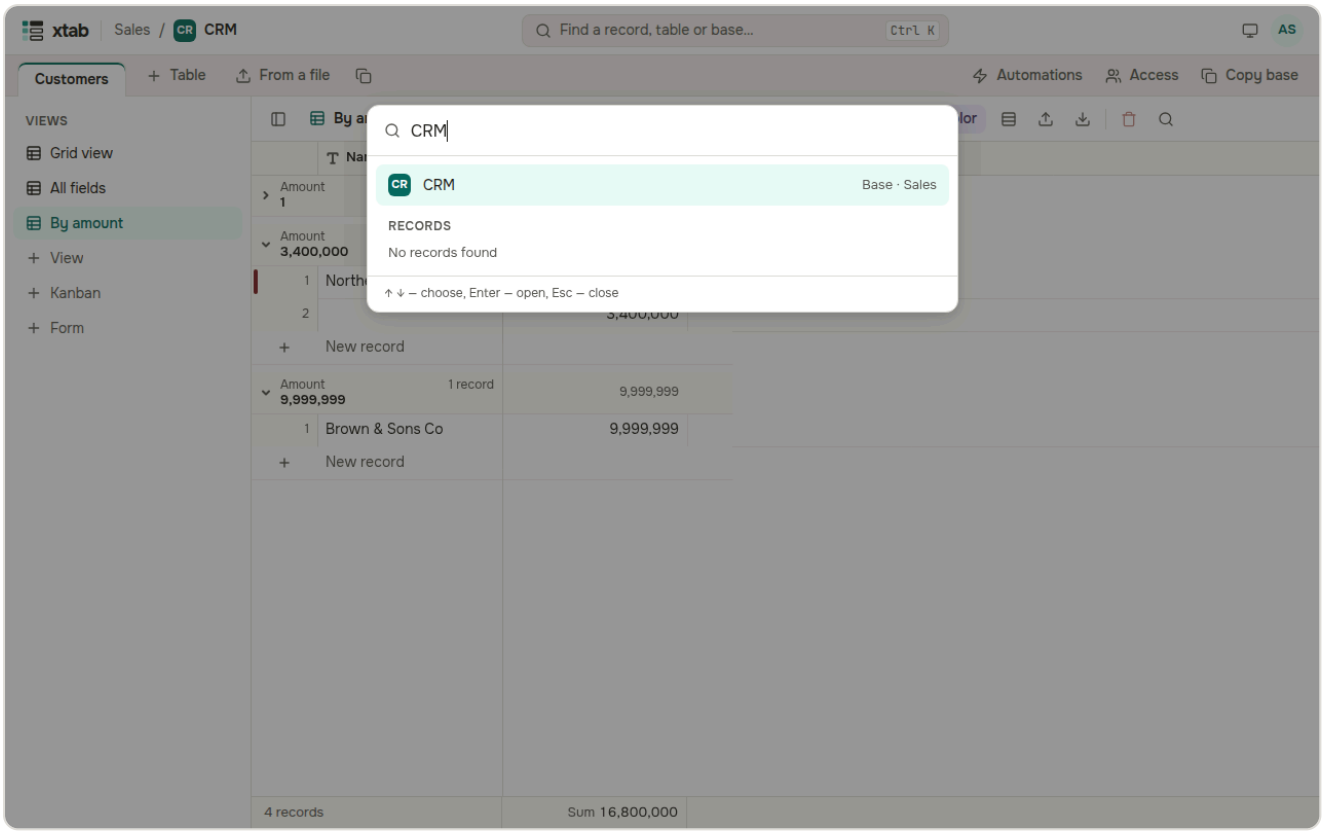
Outgoing addresses

A page of the administrator of the organization (the menu of the account → **Outgoing addresses**): where automations may send requests and letters. By default nowhere outside: letters go to members of the organization only.

- **Allowed hosts**, one a line: `api.example.com`, `*.example.com` (all subdomains) or an IP address. **Any host** opens every address; it asks for the password again.
- **Allowed addresses of letters**: addresses outside the organization automations may write to.
- **Domains of invitations**: when set, only addresses of these domains can be invited into the organization; letters of automations may go to them too.

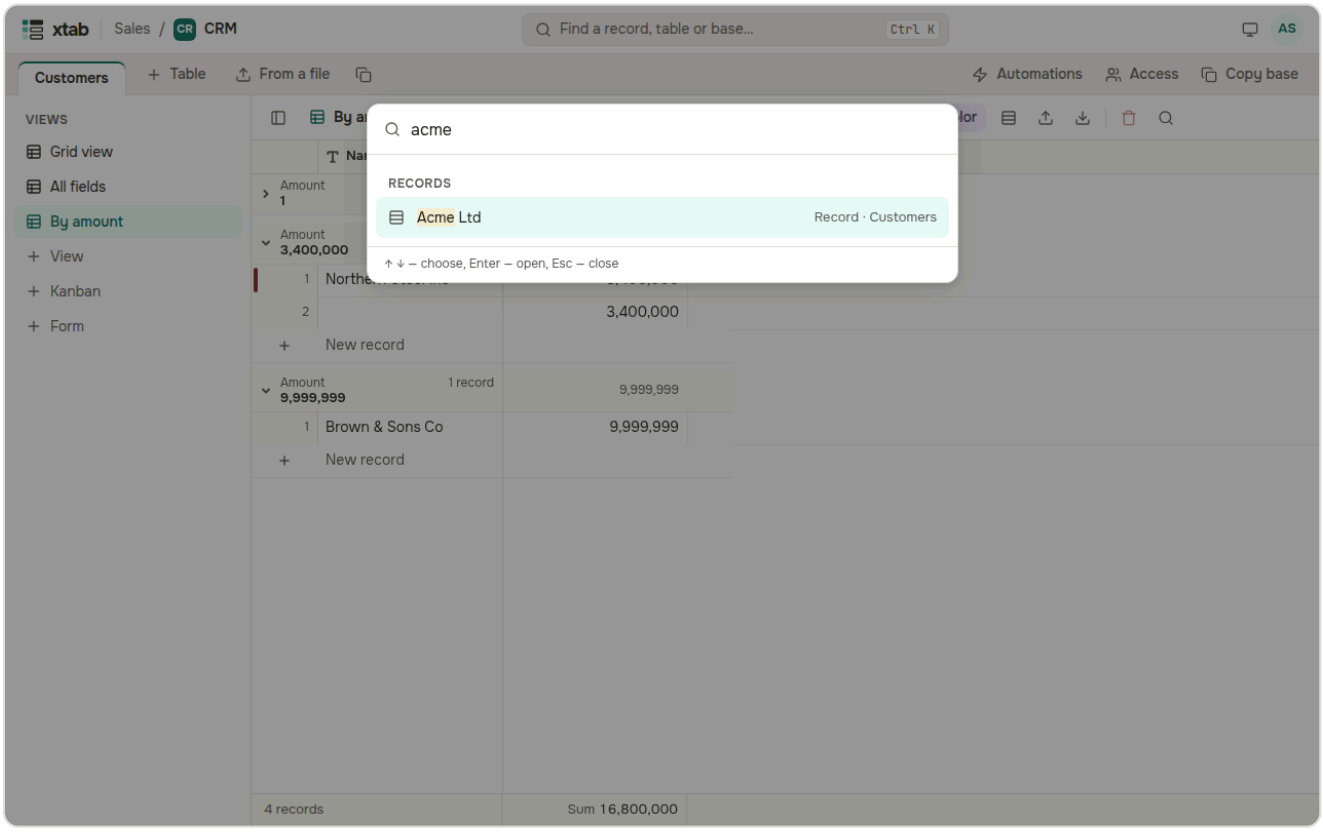
Quick jump

Press Ctrl+K (⌘K on a Mac) or click **Find a record, table or base...** at the top. Start typing the name of a base or a table or the text of a record, choose a result with the arrows and press Enter.



Quick jump

A record found opens expanded in its table.



A record in the quick jump

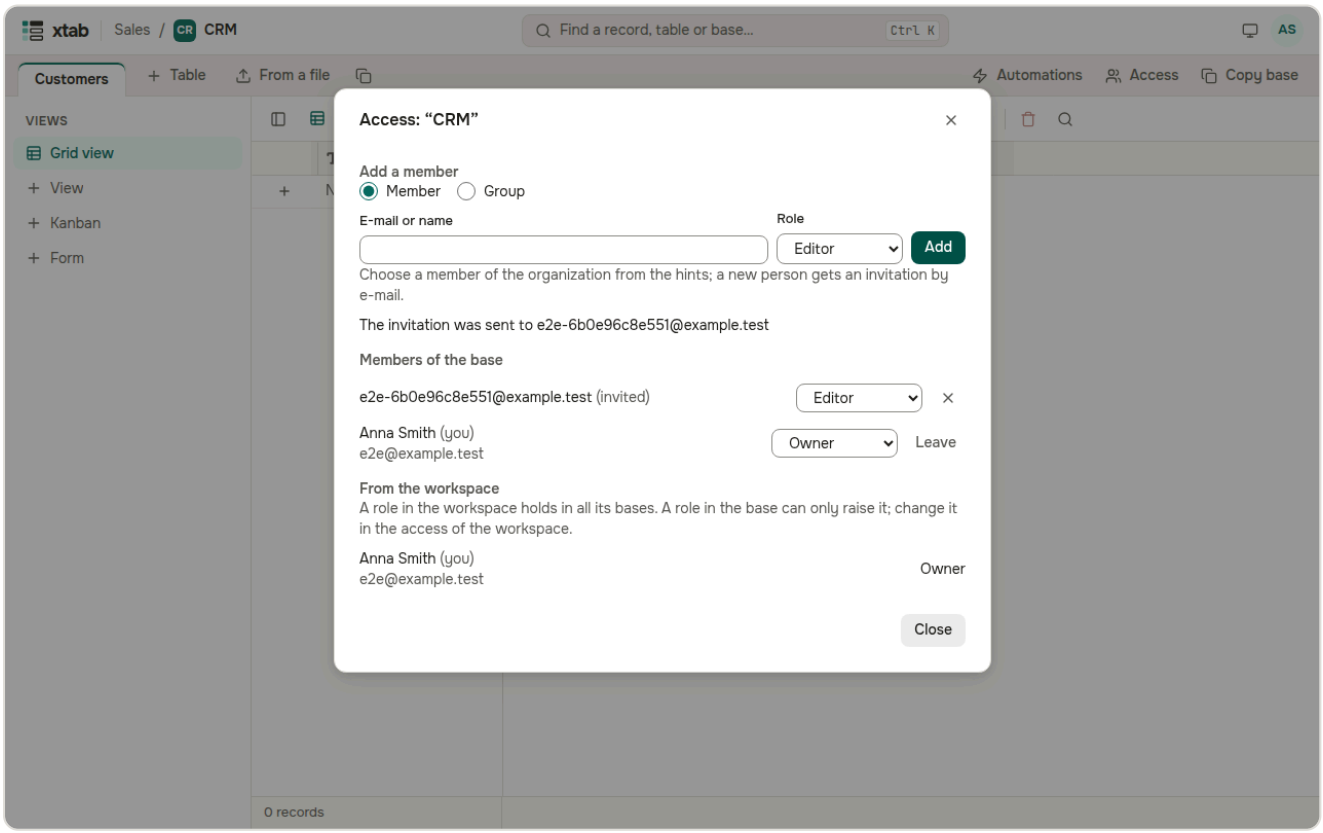
Working together

Changes by other people appear in your table by themselves, without reloading the page: new and deleted records, edits of cells, new fields.

Access to a workspace and a base

Who works in a base is shown by the **Access** button at the end of the row of table tabs; a workspace has the same button in its heading on the start page.

- The dialog lists the members with their roles: a **Reader** sees the data, a **Commenter** also comments, an **Editor** changes records, a **Creator** changes tables, fields and views, an **Owner** manages everything, access included.
- A role in the workspace holds in all its bases. The dialog of a base shows such members apart — “From the workspace”; a role in the base can only raise it.
- To add a person, enter their e-mail or name, choose a role and press **Add**. A member of the organization can be picked from the hints — the role appears at once; a new person gets an invitation by e-mail.
- A role is changed in the list next to the person; the cross removes access. A creator gives roles up to Editor, an owner any role. The last owner cannot be removed.
- The **Leave** button on your own row removes your own access.
- A role can be given to a group too: choose **Group** in the form, then the group and the role. Every member of the group gets the role.

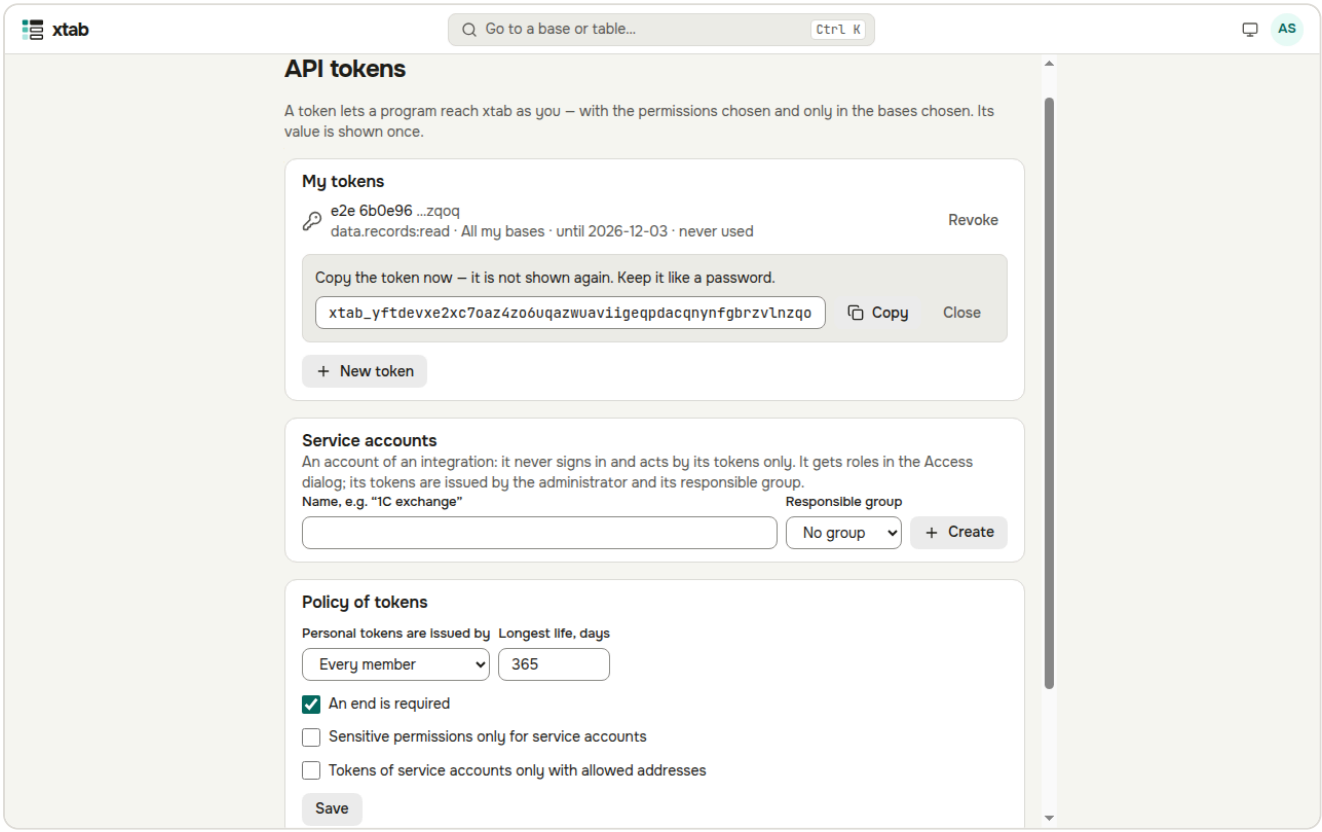


Access to a base

API tokens

A token lets a program (a 1C exchange, a BI report) reach xtab as you. **Account menu → API tokens**.

- **New token**: enter what it is for, tick the permissions (sensitive ones are marked), choose all your bases or only some, the life and, if needed, the addresses it may be used from. xtab asks for your password.
- The value of the token is shown once — press **Copy** and keep it like a password. Afterwards only its last four characters are shown.
- **Revoke** switches the token off at once.
- **Service accounts** are for integrations that must not depend on an employee. The administrator creates them, they get roles in the Access dialog, and their tokens are issued by the administrator and the members of the responsible group.



API tokens

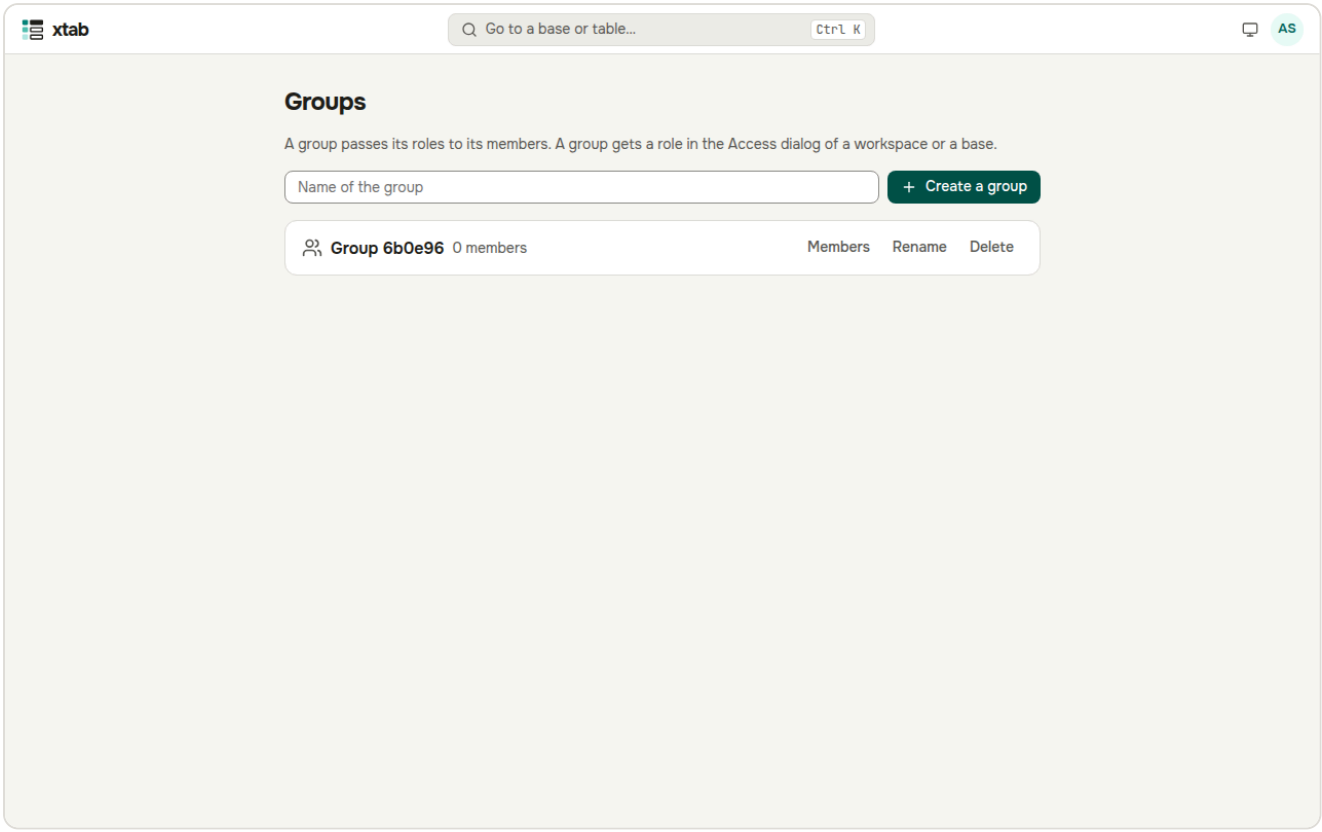
- The administrator of the organization sets the policy of tokens here too (who issues them, the longest life, limits) and sees every token of the organization.

Groups

The administrator of the organization keeps groups: **account menu → Groups**.

- Enter a name and press **Create a group**.
- **Members** opens who is in the group: add a person by e-mail or name, the cross takes them out. If you add yourself to a group that has roles, xtab asks for your password.

- **Rename** and **Delete** are on each group. Deleting a group also removes the access it gave.



Groups

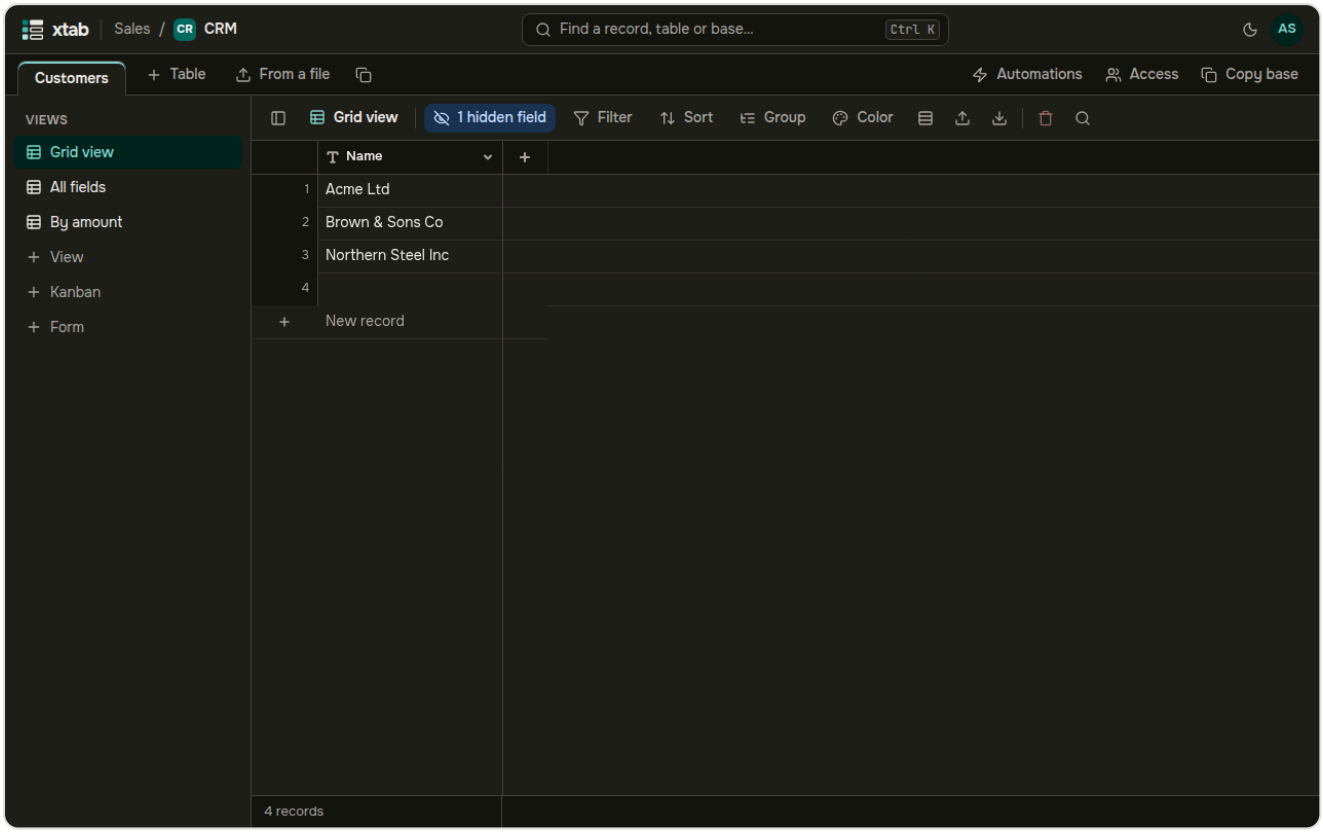
API for integrations

Programs — a 1C exchange, BI reports, your own scripts — work with xtab through its REST API.

- Get a token: **account menu** → **API tokens** (for an integration, prefer a service account, see “API tokens” above).
- The address of the API is the address of xtab plus `/api/v1`, e.g. `https://xtab.example.ru/api/v1/tables/{table}/records`. Every method is described in the OpenAPI specification of the documentation set.
- The token goes in a header: `Authorization: Bearer xtab_…`. A token in the address or in a cookie is not accepted.
- A token acts with the rights of its owner, but only within the permissions and bases chosen. Without a permission, xtab answers `403` and names it; a revoked, expired token or one from a foreign address gets `401`.
- The rate of requests is limited: by default 20 a second per token, with room for 50 in a row. Beyond the limit the answer is `429`; the header `Retry-After` says in how many seconds to retry, and `RateLimit` how many requests are left.

Theme

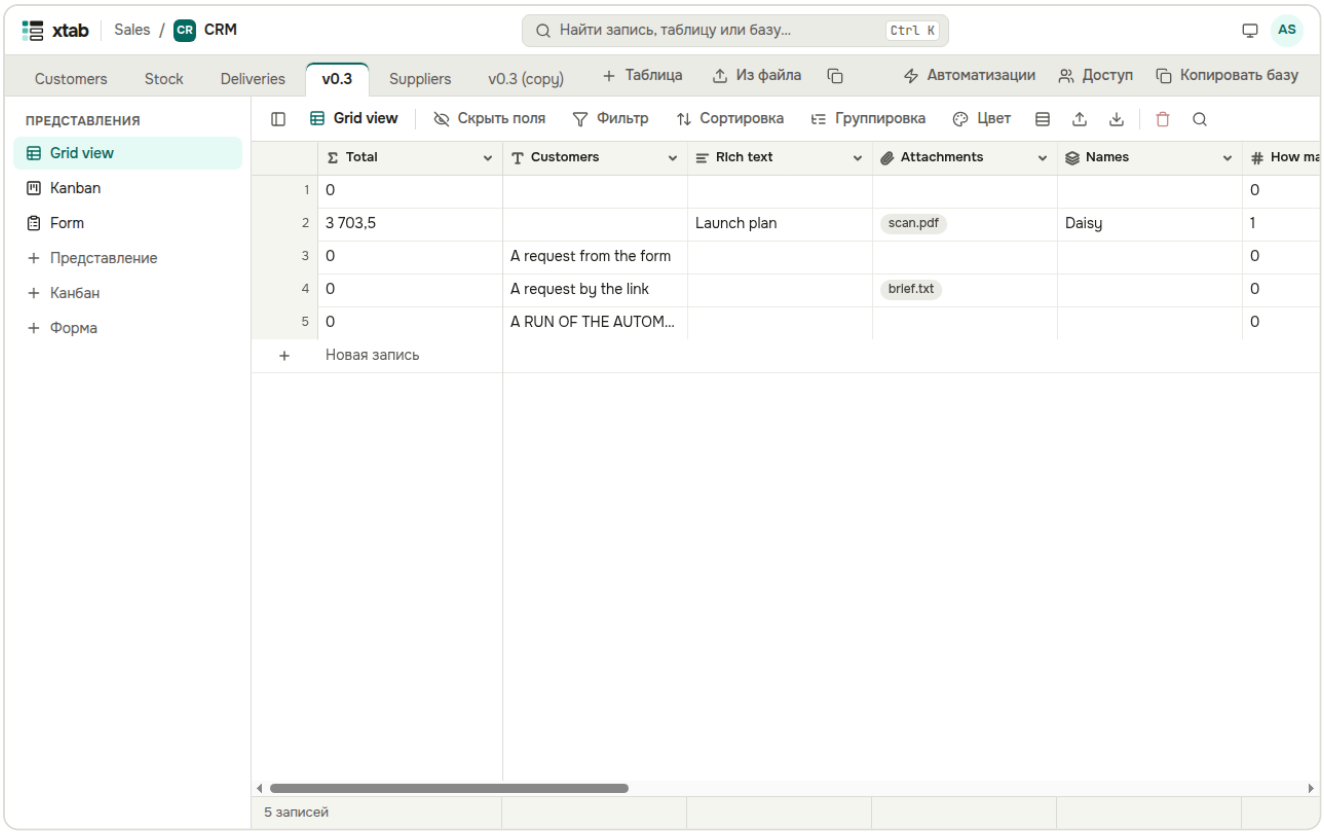
The button to the left of the circle with your initials switches the theme: as in the system, light, dark. The choice is remembered in this browser.



The dark theme

Interface language

xtab speaks Russian and English. By default the language is that of the browser. To choose another, click the circle with your initials and choose **Language: English**, **Language: Русский** or **Language: as in the browser**. The choice is remembered in your account. Numbers and dates in a table are written as the chosen language writes them.



The interface in Russian